

1. Reasons for the Hijrah

A discussion for the reasons behind the emigration of the Prophet (saw) and early Muslims

The Year of Sadness

The tenth year of the prophetic mission is known as the year of sadness. Through its course, the prophet (pbuh) had been bereft of the comfort and emotional support of his beloved wife Khadija and the physical protection of his uncle Abu Talib, who had both passed on earlier that year¹. To make matters worse, Abu Talib had been replaced as chief of Bani Hashim by Abu Lahab; one of the worst opponents of the prophet (pbuh)². Almost the whole of Mecca was seething with hatred and malice towards the prophet (pbuh); whose life was in constant danger as he stood alone before the masses of idolaters, hungry for his blood. The attacks started as dirt was thrown over the head of the prophet (pbuh) just a few days after the death of Abu Talib³, and escalated with time as it became evident that none would come to the prophet's (pbuh) aid.

Severe oppression

The prophet (pbuh) had known this was coming, until a short time ago the Meccans had ruthlessly barred all trade and support for the Muslims. While Abu Talib had been on his deathbed, the prophet (pbuh) had attempted to establish security by inviting the Quraysh one last time to, *'rule over the Arabs, and the Persians shall be your subjects'*⁴. The only condition was one word, that there is no god but Allah, but the Quraysh were too arrogant and ignorant to give it. Instead, they continued torturing and persecuting the Muslims in any way possible, in an attempt to make them give up their faith. The prophet (pbuh) tried to find some support at nearby Taif, but was dismissed with a nonsensical statement from the chiefs, who said that he may or may not be the prophet but they wanted no conversation with him. Further, when the prophet (pbuh) requested their silence so that he could leave quietly, they informed the *'loafers and simpletons'* who instead attacked him and chased him out of the city⁵. This was the attitude that faced the prophet (pbuh) at every turn; he could not even return to Mecca without sending a messenger to ask Mut'am for his protection from the Quraysh, who were lying in wait for him⁶.

Unable to preach freely

With the oppressive atmosphere penetrating Mecca, the prophet (pbuh) was restricted to the sacred months to make his speeches. Most were not open to the speech of Muhammad (pbuh); some of the worst resistance he met was from his own relatives such as Abu Lahab, prompting the chiefs of other Arab tribes to ridicule the prophet (pbuh)⁷. Despite this, the prophet (pbuh) did succeed in reaching several individuals from Medina; such as Suwayd bin Samit and Ayas bin Ma'az who had openly adopted Islam. The prophet (pbuh) later met six men from the tribe of khazraj in Medina, who accepted their call to Islam and propagated it upon their return to such an extent that, *'there was no house left where the Prophet was not talked about'*⁸. Having been ravaged by war and conflict, the people at Medina were desperate for the hope of peace, which made them receptive to the ideals of Islam and conditions of the prophet (pbuh). In addition, their close contact with the Jews had prepared them for the advent of an Arab prophet⁹. In contrast to Mecca where the enmity towards Muhammad (pbuh) and his followers grew, Medina became more and more inclined towards Islam as time passed.

The assassination plot

The Quraysh were spurred into action when they heard that the prophet (pbuh) was successful in bringing his message to Medina. They understood that if in Medina the Muslims could find a base and

stronghold, they would no longer be scattered and incapable of decisive action in propagating their faith. The Quraysh knew that this heralded the start of their defeat, so they ruthlessly set about attacking every Medinan they could get their hands on. The persecution rose such that the prophet (pbuh) advised his followers to begin migrating to Medina, until there were almost none left in Mecca save the prophet (pbuh), Ali, and a handful of others¹⁰. There was no refuge for the prophet (pbuh) in Mecca, nor anyone who would hear his words. The Quraysh rapidly formulated a cowardly plot to assassinate the prophet (pbuh), whereby a group of them would kill him to avoid individual liability, yet despite their every attempt they were unable to carry it out.

Divine Aid

Allah, the Almighty, ordered the prophet (pbuh) to go to Medina, and helped him every step of the way. He sent the angel Gabriel to warn the prophet (pbuh) of the plan of Quraysh, and blinded their eyes to him, allowing him to escape¹¹. He covered the mouth of the prophet's (pbuh) hiding place with cobwebs, so that the Quraysh would pass by it without finding him¹². He caused Saraqah's horse to become startled and throw him, before he could do the prophet (pbuh) any harm¹³. And when the prophet (pbuh) got to Medina, he brought peace and brotherhood, friendship and love, and united the community under the banner of faith. Allah had taken Muhammad (pbuh) from the land that was dearest to him, to the land that He held most dear.

Allah's plan

Bloodied and weary on escaping from the mob in Taif, the messenger of Allah (pbuh) collapsed by a vine in the enemy's garden. He made a desperate plea to Allah: *'O Lord! I present my weakness and lack of strength before You. You are the kind Nourisher. You are the helper of the weak. To whom are You abandoning me?'*

The Almighty, All-Seeing and Hearing, showed His servant His purpose. A Christian slave was sent to the prophet (pbuh) to give him some grapes, and left as a Muslim after hearing only a few words from him. He recognised the truth of the prophet's (pbuh) words, and immediately embraced the faith. Though many would reject, there were a few who would believe, and it was for their sake the prophet (pbuh) had been sent. Men like the two chiefs of Bani Abdul Ashhal, who approached Islam with enmity then embraced it wholeheartedly¹⁴. Men like the old man who only heard of Muhammad (pbuh) from a party returning from pilgrimage, and declared, *'it is the very luminous star which has risen from the horizon of reality'*¹⁵. And not just men, but also jinn like Haam ibn Heem ibn Lakees ibn Iblees, and Hasheem bin Luma bin Iblees who embraced Islam at the prophet's (pbuh) hands¹⁶. The prophet (pbuh) was their hope and salvation. With his journey to Madina the prophet (pbuh) could establish an Islamic community, usher in a new era of Islamic history¹⁷, and bring Islam to the hearts of all who would receive it.

1 M. Lings, *Muhammad, His life based on the earliest sources*, Millat Book Centre (India) ch31, *'the year of sadness'*,
p.96

2 M. Lings, *Muhammad, His life based on the earliest sources*, Millat Book Centre (India) ch31, *'the year of sadness'*,
p.98

3 J. Subhani, *The Message*, ch.23, *'Journey to Taif'*

4 as 1 above

5 as 1 above

6 J. Subhani, *The Message*, ch.23, *'Journey to Taif: The Prophet returns to Makkah'*

- 7 J. Subhani, *The Message*, ch.23, '*Journey to Taif: invitation to the heads of the tribes during hajj season*'
- 8 J. Subhani, *The Message*, ch.24, '*the agreement of Aqabah: the details of this event*'
- 9 J. Subhani, *The Message*, ch.24, '*the agreement of Aqabah: the condition of Muslims after the agreement of Aqabah*'
- 10 J. Subhani, *The Message*, ch.24, '*the agreement of Aqabah: fear over takes Quraysh*'
- 11 J. Subhani, *The Message*, ch.25, '*The event of migration: the archangel Jibreel informs the Prophet*'
- 12 J. Subhani, *The Message*, ch.25, '*The event of migration: the Quraysh do not hesitate in searching out the Prophet*'
- 13 J. Subhani, *The Message*, ch.25, '*The event of migration: schedule of the journey*'
- 14 J. Subhani, *The Message*, ch.24, '*the agreement of Aqabah: the spiritual influence of Islam*'
- 15 J. Subhani, *The Message*, ch.24, '*the agreement of Aqabah*'
- 16 M. B. Majlisi [tr. J. L. Merrick] (1997), '*The life and religion of Muhammad, Hiyat al Qulub*', pp.178-180
- 17 J. Subhani, *The Message*, ch.25, '*The event of migration: Why the year of Migration became the era of Islamic History*'

2. The Significance of the Hijrah

In Surah Tawbah, 9:20

Al-Tawbah, 9:20 Those who believe, and suffer exile and strive with might and main, in Allah's cause, with their goods and their persons, have the highest rank in the sight of Allah: they are the people who will achieve (salvation).

Surah Tawbah, 9:21

Al-Tawbah, 9:21 Their Lord doth give them glad tidings of a Mercy from Himself, of His good pleasure, and of gardens for them, wherein are delights that endure:

Surah, Tawbah, 9:22 They will dwell therein for ever. Verily in Allah's presence is a reward, the greatest (of all).

The significance of Hijrah (the migration of Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) to Madinah) is not limited to the Islamic history or to the Muslims. The Hijrah not only reshaped - socially and politically - the Arab Peninsula, but also had its impact on worldwide civilizations.

Throughout the history of Islam, the migration was a transitional line between the two major eras, regarding to the message of Islam; the era of Makkah and the era of Madinah. In its essence, this signified a transition from one phase to another, as follows:

Transition from the position of weakness, where the non-believers of Makkah — particularly the people of Quraish — humiliated, tortured and killed Muslims, to the position of strength. This is where Muslims were allowed to defend themselves and were able to defeat their adversaries.

Transition from spreading Islam through individual *Da'wah* (inviting others to Islam) to the spreading of Islam through institutionalized *Da'wah*, initiated by the state.

Transition from a position where Muslims represented a small group of people, surrounded by enemies and threatened by death, to the position of a regional power with a strong central leadership. This was one that was surrounded by a large number of followers and allies.

Transition of *Da'wah* from regionalism, in which the focus was only on Quraish and the tribes surrounding Makkah, to the phase of universalism. This is where the Muslim State began reaching out to Persia, Egypt, and the Byzantine Empire.

Transition from being a simple Islamic group of believers, to being the Islamic Ummah (nation). This is which was an organized Islamic state, with a central leadership and other organizations.

Transition, which is most significantly for early Muslims, to the phase in which Islam was not only the act of worship, but a way of life. This was encompassing (surrounding) politics, economy, social interactions and every other aspect of life. This was the first time when Islam was looked upon as a **comprehensive** religion.

This contrast between the two periods is clearly noticeable in the Qur'anic discourse. Muslim scholars describe the part of Qur'an that was revealed in Makkah as the Makkan Qur'an, and that which was revealed in Madinah as the Madini Qur'an.

Although both parts are intermingled in the Qur'an and constitute one divine script, the discourse of both parts is clearly distinguishable. Whereas the part revealed in Makkah concentrated on *Tawheed* (the Oneness of Allah/monotheism), the part revealed in Madinah covered rules regarding Islamic life in general.

There is no doubt whatsoever that the migration of Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) to Madinah was the crucial event, which established the Islamic civilization. This was a civilization that thrived for many centuries.

Hijrah, the turning point in Islamic history

Hijrah, no doubt, kindled the light of hope in the hearts of the early Muslims who set a shining example for all Muslims, in every generation, to emulate.

Hijrah, in essence, is a process of transfer to a better situation. It is not meant to find a comfortable place where one would relax and stop endeavor (attempt). Rather, it is a search for an environment more favorable to continuous and constructive effort. Immediately after reaching Madinah, the Prophet undertook an all-embracing process to establish a faithful and strong society. This is a significant aspect and important lesson to learn from Hijrah.

In the Glorious Qur'an, Allah, Most High, says, "**Those who believe, and migrate and strive in Allah's cause, with their goods and their persons, have the highest rank in the sight of Allah: they are indeed the successful people. Their Lord does give them glad tidings of a Mercy from Himself, of His good pleasure, and of Gardens where enduring pleasure will be theirs: They will dwell therein forever. Verily in Allah's presence is a reward, the greatest (of all).**" (Al-Tawbah 9: 20-22)

Our religious calendar is the Hijri calendar. It is important for us to keep in mind the meaning and significance of Hijrah.

Hijrah was one of the most important events in the history of Islam. It is for this reason `Umar (may Allah be pleased with him) adopted Hijrah date to calculate years. Muslims chose Hijrah as the focal point to reckon their chronology. In physical terms, Hijrah was a journey between two cities about 200 miles apart, but in its grand significance it marked the beginning of an era, a civilization, a culture and a history for the whole mankind. Islam progressed not only from the physical Hijrah, but because Muslims took Hijrah seriously in all its aspects and dimensions.

When the Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) made the Hijrah from Makkah to Madinah, he did not just transfer his residence or took shelter in another city, but as soon as he arrived in Madinah he began the transformation of that city in every aspect.

It is important for us to study and reflect on the things that he did in Madinah. There are many lessons for us in that history and we can learn many things for our life.

1. Masjid (Mosque): The Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) first established a *Masjid* for the worship of Allah. He himself worked in carrying the stones and building that small, humble but most powerful structure. This was the beginning, but soon other *Masajid* (mosques) were established in Madinah.

2. Madrasah (Islamic school and educational institution for the community): The first school under the supervision of the Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) was the school of *Suffah*. Later many other schools were opened. According to Maulana Shibli Numani, there were nine schools opened in Madinah alone in the time of the Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him).

3. Mu'akhah: He established brotherly relations between the *Muhajirun* (Muslims who migrated from Makkah) and the *Ansar* (residents of Madinah who helped the Prophet and his Companions). *Masjid* and *Madrasah* were not enough; what was also important was to have good relations between Muslims. They should have their brotherhood on the basis of faith, not on the basis of tribes as they used to have prior to Islam.

4. Intercommunity and Interfaith Relations: Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) also established good relations with other communities living in Madinah. There was a large Jewish community as well as some other Arab tribes who had not accepted Islam. The Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) prepared a *Mithaq* (a covenant or a constitution) for relations between these communities.

5. Cleaning the City: Yathrib (previous name of Madinah) was a dirty city. When the *Sahabah* (Prophet's Companions) came from Makkah to Madinah, many of them got sick and did not like that city. The Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) asked them to clean the city and remove its dirt and filth. `Aishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said: "We came to Madinah and it was the most polluted land of Allah. The water there was most stinking. (Al-Bukhari, 1756)

6. Water System in the City: The Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) asked the *Sahabah* to dig wells in different parts of the city. It is mentioned that more than 50 wells were opened in the city

of Madinah and there was enough clean water for every one.

7. Agriculture and Gardening: The Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) encouraged the *Sahabah* to cultivate the land and make gardens. He told them that any one who would cultivate any dead land, would own it. Many people started working and cultivating and soon there was enough food for every one.

8. Poverty Eradication: In a short period of time it happened that there were no poor people in Madinah. Every one had enough and the Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) used to give gifts to coming delegations.

9. Safety, Security, Law and Order: Madinah became the safest city in the world. There were very few incidents of theft, rape, drunkenness or murder and they were immediately taken care of.

In short, Hijrah teaches us that wherever Muslims go, they should bring goodness to that land. Muslims should work for both moral and material goodness of the society.

***Hijrah* is obligatory**

Hijrah is obligatory on Muslims if they are unable to practice their religion in the country they are living in, and if they are facing serious persecutions and find themselves unable to overcome them. In such cases, if they are faced with the choice of renouncing their religion or going to a place where they can readily practice it, they are obligated to emigrate.

However, *hijrah* should not be an option to consider if what we said is not the case, as Muslims are ordered to struggle to establish their faith wherever they live. The Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) said: "**Jihad (struggle in the path of Allah to establish His religion) is an ongoing duty until the Day of Resurrection.**"

There is no *hijrah* from Makkah to Madinah or anywhere else after Makkah surrendered to the laws of Islam.

As far as emigration for economic reasons is concerned, it will be reckoned accordingly. The Prophet (peace and blessings be upon him) said: "**Actions are judged by intentions and everyone will be judged according to his intention. So whoever emigrates for the sake of Allah and His Messenger, his *hijrah* will be reckoned as done for Allah and His Messenger. But whoever emigrates for worldly reasons or marrying a woman, his *hijrah* will be reckoned accordingly.**"

Having said this, the economic emigrants living in the West can, however, transform their *hijrah* into an act of *`Ibadah* (worship) if they change the intention and dedicate themselves to be ambassadors of Islam in their new home.

Did other Prophets perform Hijrah?

A *Hijrah* was not something special for Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him). Rather, some of Allah's Prophets emigrated before Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him). Yet, the *Hijrah* of Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him) differed from those of other Prophets because it was not intended as a flight from torture but as the beginning of the Islamic State.

The eminent Muslim scholar, **Sheikh Yusuf Al-Qaradawi**, states the following:

Most of Allah's Messengers, if not all, emigrated. However, their emigrations differed from that of Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him). For example, Prophet Ibrahim (peace and

blessing be upon him) emigrated, as related in the Qur'an: **(And Lot believed him, and said: Lo! I am a fugitive unto my Lord. Lo! He, only He, is the Mighty, the Wise)** (Al-`Ankabut 29: 26). In another verse, Allah Almighty says: **(And he said: Lo! I am going unto my Lord Who will guide me)** (As-Saffat 37: 99). So, Prophet Ibrahim (peace and blessings be upon him) migrated from place to place till he settled at a town in Palestine, where he was then buried. That town, Al-Khalil Ibrahim, (Hebron) is now named after him.

Prophet Musa (peace and blessings be upon him) also emigrated before he was assigned with the divine mission. He fled from Egypt after he had mistakenly killed an Egyptian. He sought Allah's forgiveness for that, and a man advised him to get out of Egypt in order to escape people's revenge. Allah Almighty says: **(And a man came from the uttermost part of the city, running. He said: O Moses! Lo! the chiefs take counsel against thee to slay thee; therefore escape. Lo! I am of those who give thee good advice. So he escaped from thence, fearing, vigilant. He said: My Lord! Deliver me from the wrongdoing folk)** (Al-Qasas 28: 20-21).

Then Prophet Musa (peace and blessings be upon him) went to a country called Madyan, where he married the daughter of a righteous old man (Prophet Shu'aib, peace be upon him) and stayed with him for ten years. Throughout that period, Musa had no divine mission. He lived as a righteous man, a good husband, and a generous son-in-law; however, he had no prominent role to perform.

That is to say, Prophet Musa (peace and blessings be upon him) emigrated for fear of revenge. He said, as related in the Qur'an: **(Then I fled from you when I feared you, and my Lord vouchsafed me a command and appointed me (of the number) of those sent (by Him))** (Ash-Shu'ara' 42: 21). On the other hand, the Hijrah of Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him) was not only to escape temptation and torture of his people. It was the starting point to establish the Muslim Ummah, a new Muslim community based on Islam, the universal divine message that calls for morality and human rights. That was the very purpose of Prophet Muhammad's Hijrah to Madinah, and he (peace and blessings be upon him) performed his role as best as possible. He put the foundation of a sound Muslim community and established the best Ummah ever created.

3. The Medina Charter (Dustar al-Madinah)

Madina Charter The First Islamic Constitution For All

The earliest recorded constitution, the Charter concerns the rights and responsibilities of the Muslim, Jewish, and other Arab and tribal communities of Medina during the war between that city and its neighbours.

Medina Charter was created by the Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) in the year 622 CE, it was the first written constitution in the Islamic world. The Medina Charter contained every aspect of running a country from politic to the human rights administration. Do the Muslim majority country now really follow what the Prophet had laid down for mankind to follow? The Medina Charter consists of 47 clauses. 23 clause governed the relationship between Muslims, between Ansar and Muhajirin, while the remaining 24 clauses governed the relations of Muslims with

non-Muslims, the Jews and others. In addition to the charter of Medina, it is also known by various names such as Medina agreement, Dustar al-Madinah and Al-Madinah Sahifah. The Medina Charter form the constitution for Medina which was based from the regulations of Islamic law to establish a pure Islamic state that puts people of different races or ethnic groups in one country living peacefully. The main contents in the Charter were the declaration that the Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) is the head of state to all the people of Medina and any dispute shall be referred to him. All the people of Medina is forbidden to plant a hostile or envy among themselves, instead they should be united as one and be known as nation of Medina. All residents are free to practice their customs and religious ceremonies respectively. All residents of Medina should cooperate in economic and if Medina to be attacked by outsiders all the citizen shall defend its. The Jews freedom are guaranteed as long as they obey the agreements listed in the charter. The purposed of the Medina Charter was to face a plural society of Medina and was to establish rules that will be complied by all the people. The charter also provide elements to unite people of various races and to establish peace and eliminate any hostility that was occurring before the arrival of Prophet Muhammad to Medina. The Medina Charter also determined the rights and duties of Prophet Muhammad and the local population. It's also provide guidelines for the Muhajirin (immigrants) recovery and providing help either material or non material to them after losing everything for leaving Mecca. Political union was also formed to defend Medina from any foreign enemy. The Charter give a clear guarantee for the right of the non Muslim and the Jews. Medina Charter was not only the first Islamic constitution but it was also the first human right charter that provided the basic rights of every human living in Medina. Medina Charter was created based on Holy Koran and Sunnah. Therefore the Holy Koran and Sunnah are the source of state law. The charter also was an instrument to unite the nation and a signed of a state sovereignty. Other principles that contain in the charter were; Freedom of movement and the right to live in Medina, rights and duties in terms of defending and maintaining the State. It also provide good relations and mutual help among all citizens and individual responsibility and government duty in upholding social justice. Some security laws such as penalties and so forth have been listed as Qisas. Religious freedom was also guarantee and the responsibility of states to non-Muslims. It also stated the duty of all parties toward bringing and upholding peace in the State. It is justified to say the Medina Charter produced a form of government that adheres to the shura system (parliamentary system) where citizen can give opinions. The charter had a great impact toward the development of Islamic civilization, especially in politics and the human rights of the ordinary citizen. The Medina Charter shows that Islam can be practiced in creating an efficient and just government.

However the Muslim majority countries all over the world now are facing with all kind of problems from their own making and its has nothing to do with the western power. The western countries succeed in developing their countries because they are implementing the rules and regulations that are suitable to them. But the Islamic countries either copying from the west and failed because does not conform to the norms of the majority or created a new form of system that only suitable to the iron claws of the power hungry politician. In the end the people suffered and Islam which should be the way of living is only used during birth of a child, marriage and death! The Muslim leaders does not even respect the human rights that the Prophet had lay down 1400 years ago. The rights of the people either Muslim or non-Muslim has been discriminate for years as if the Medina Charter been kept and locked in the dusty shelves. From Gamal Nasir to Muamar Kahdafi none has ever used or implemented the true Islamic law in administering their countries. An Islamic scholar and politician from Malaysia, who was disappointed with his country freedom of expression restriction once commented, "Sometime the European are more Islamic than the Muslim!".

It is safe to say that not a single country of the Muslim majority countries or even the terrorist group such as Al-Qaeda are practising the true Islamic governance that the Prophet taught and lived by. Maybe it is time for every leader to start reading the Medina Charter and give the people their rights as what Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) taught

Al-Madinah Charter: Pride of Islamic Civilization

After prophet muhammad (saws) emigrated to al-madinah in 623 c.e., he drew a historical charter. Many historians praised it and considered it one of the prides of islamic civilization and a hallmark of its political and humane glory. This charter aimed mainly to organize the relationship among all the sects and groups living in al-madinah at the time, especially the emigrants, ansar, and jewish parties, in order for all of them to defend their town against ant external invasion or assault.

By drawing this charter, all parties concerned approved that al-madinah would be a collective state whose president is prophet muhammad (saws) and whose main reference is islamic shari'ah. all human rights became guaranteed, such as belief, rites, equality, and justice.

Roman historian gorgio wrote that "this charter contained fifty-two articles formulated by prophet muhammad (saws) himself: twenty-five were related to muslims' affairs and twenty-seven were related the relation between muslims and others, especially the jews and idolaters. this charter was drawn in such a way that provided the chance for all beliefs to live together along with muslims in a peaceful way and gave them the freedom to observe their rites provided that no other is annoyed. it also stated the need for unity against any outsider who may attack al-madinah."

Let us take a look at the main points in this charter.

first: ummah is above tribalism

"They are one community (ummah) to the exclusion of all men."

this was the second article by which the whole ummah was merged and belonging to islam prevailed over any other tribal belonging or bias. prophet muhammad (saws) raised arab from the tribal level to the ummah level.

Second: social solidarity among all

"Quraysh emigrants according to their present custom shall pay the bloodwit within their number and shall redeem their prisoners with the kindness and justice common among believers."

"Banu 'auf according to their present custom shall pay the bloodwit they paid in heathenism; every section shall redeem its prisoners with the kindness and justice common among believers."

"Banu sa'ida, the b. 'l-harith, and the b. jusham, and the b. al-najjar likewise."

"Banu 'amr bin 'auf, banu an-nabit and banu al-'aus likewise."

Third: deterrence of traitors

"Allah-fearing believers shall be against the rebellious or him who seeks to spread injustice, or sin or animosity, or corruption among believers; the hand of every man shall be against him even if he is a son of one of them."

This is a provision for using arms against any sect inside al-madinah if it attacks Muslims. Therefore, banu qurayzah's treason after al-ahzab battle was punished because they cooperated with the attacking armies and betrayed their hometown.

Fourth: respect of Muslim's protection

"Allah's protection is one, the least of them may give protection to a stranger on their behalf. believers are friends one to the other to the exclusion of outsiders."

Therefore, it was the right of any muslim to provide protection to any person and the others should respect this and protect the same person even if the provider of this protection is the lowest person among them, men and women included.

Fifth: protection of non-muslims and minorities

“To the jew who follows us belong help and equality. he shall not be wronged nor shall his enemies be aided.”

it is a text that should be deeply praised as uniquely fair and just. muslim state protects all its citizens regardless their beliefs as long as they do their duties and fulfill their promises.

Sixth: social security and blood-money

“whoever is convicted of killing a believer without good reason shall be subject to retaliation unless the next of kin is satisfied (with blood-money), and the believers shall be against him as one man, and they are bound to take action against him.”

Therefore, the charter guaranteed justice and compensation and put an end to the pre-islamic vendetta. this resulted in prevalent stability and security.

Seventh: shari’ah is the main reference

“Whenever you differ about a matter it must be referred to Allah (swt) and to muhammad.”

“If any dispute or controversy likely to cause trouble should arise it must be referred to god and to muhammad the messenger of Allah. Allah accepts what is nearest to piety and goodness in this document.”

Eighth: freedom of worship is guaranteed for all

“The jews of the banu ‘auf are one community with the believers (the jews have their religion and the muslims have theirs), their freedmen and their persons except those who behave unjustly and sinfully, for they hurt but themselves and their families.”

Ninth: financial support to defend state is the responsibility of all

“The jews shall contribute to the cost of war so long as they are fighting alongside the believers.”

Tenth: financial independent of each sect

“The jews must bear their expenses and the muslims their expenses.”

Eleventh: joint defence against any aggression

“The contracting parties are bound to help one another against any attack on yathrib.”

“Each must help the other against anyone who attacks the people of this document.”

this clearly indicates the necessity of joint defence against any attack.

Twelfth: advice and good dealings between Muslims and people of the scriptures

“The parties of this document shall advise and consult each other without any bad intention.”

Thirteenth: freedom of each party to enter into unharmful alliances

“Neither party shall pay for the wrongs of its allies.”

Fourteenth: support of the wronged

“The wronged shall be supported until they get their rights.”

Fifteenth: security is the right for all

“This deed will not protect the unjust and the sinner. The man who goes forth to fight and the man who stays at home in the city are safe unless he has been unjust and sinned. Allah is the protector of the good and Allah-fearing man and muhammad is the messenger of Allah.”

Islam really is always a pioneer in many aspects. This charter is just one example of real equality and fraternity that was realized on the ground and not only ideally preached.

4. The Battle of Badr

In the second year of the Hijrah, during the month of Ramadan, the Muslims came up against the infidels in the decisive battle of Badr which was to prove the turning point not only in the destiny of Islam but of the entire human race.

Background of the Battle

The circumstances that led to this battle began with the news received by the Prophet (s.a.w.) that a great caravan with lots of money and merchandise, was being led by Abu Sufyan on its way back to Makkah from Syria. A state of belligerence already existed between the Muslims and the Quraish, for the latter was doing all in their power to harm and abuse the Muslims, to impede their progress and to seize their rising power. They were sparing none of their financial and physical resources to get on the job and their armed detachments very often waded deep into the limits of Madeenah and its pastures to pound upon the Muslims.

Abu Sufyan, was one of the worst enemies of Islam, therefore, the Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) asked the Muslims to get ready to intercept the caravan. However, since it was a commercial caravan the Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) did not make any elaborate arrangements for fighting, but merely positioned himself in order to catch it flat-footed.

Informed of the Prophet's (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) decision to stop him, Abu Sufyan sent a courier to Makkah with an urgent request for reinforcements. Thereupon, the Quraish ably supported and accompanied by all the notable chiefs of Makkah hastily formed an armed force. Such support group enlisted every man available therein from the neighbouring tribes - and this army went forth to assist the caravan. The Quraish were so flared up that hardly a man was left behind in Makkah.

FAITHFULNESS OF THE ANSAAR

News came to the Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) that a strong Makkan army was on its way to engage him in a battle. The Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) thereupon summoned his followers and solicited for their advice. The Muhajirin responded first the Ansaar and assured him of their help and loyalty. The Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) was delighted to hear the replies given by his companions. He said, "Go ahead with glad tidings."⁽²⁾

ENTHUSIASM OF THE YOUNGSTERS

When the detachments went out from Madeenah, a boy of sixteen, whose name was 'Umair b. Abi Waqqas also accompanied the warriors stealthily because he feared that if the Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) saw him, he would send him back due to his juvenile age. (Usd ul-Ghaba, Vol. IV, p. 148)

STRENGTH OF THE CONTENDING PARTIES

The Prophet rallied forth to the battlefield with three hundred and thirteen combatants who were not even well-equipped. The Muslims had seventy camels and two horses on which men rode by turns; (Zad al-ma'ad, Vol. I, p. 342) there was nothing to distinguish the soldiers from the captains, not even the eminent companions like Abu Bakr and 'Umar or the Prophet himself bore any mark of distinction.

The standard banner of the army was given to Mus'ab b. 'Umayr, the flag of the Muhajirin was with 'Ali and that of the Ansaar with S'ad b. Muadh.

Upon learning of the approaching Muslim army, Abu Sufyan turned his caravan towards the seacoast. He also sent word to the Quraish army, when he was at a safe distance from the Muslims, to go back home as it was no longer essential for them to proceed ahead. Many of the Makkans too wanted to

return home but Abu Jahl insisted to charge ahead in order to punish the raiders. His forces were a thousand strong with all the veterans and noted fighters of Makkah and all were well-armed. He did not want to miss the opportunity to engage the Muslims in battle. (Zad al-Ma'ad, Vol. I, p. 343 and Ibn Hisham, Vol. pp. 618-19) On coming to know the names of the Makkan chiefs accompanying Abu Jahl, the Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) remarked: "Makkah has brought the pieces of heart to you!"

THE DEMOCRATIC WAY

The Quraish army halted on reaching a Wadi (valley) near Badr while the Muslims pitched their tents on the other side of the enemy. Later Prophet moved the army to another place nearer to the water (wells of Badr) according to the suggestion of Hubab b. Al-Mundhir. (Ibn Hisham, Vol. I, p. 620)

Allah sent down rain during the night, which caused the infidels great inconvenience by hindering their movement as He said "And he sent down water from the sky upon you, that thereby he might purify you, and remove from you the fear of Satan, and make strong your hearts and firm (your) feet thereby." [Qur'an 8:11]

PREPARATION FOR THE FIGHTING

This was the night of Friday, the seventeenth of Ramadan. At the first manifestation of the morning, the entire force of the Quraish streamed out into the valley and distributed themselves in the battlefield while the Muslims positioned before them in the foreground. (Zad al-Ma'ad, Vol. pp. 343-344)

THE TRUE POSITION AND STATURE OF THE MUSLIMS

The Prophet returned to his men before the battle and delivered a short speech stressing the merits of fighting in the way of God.

Now 'Ubayda being the eldest, confronted 'Utba b. Rabi'a. Hamza faced Shayba and 'Ali came full blast against Waleed. With a swift dispatch, Hamza and 'Ali slew their opponents, but 'Ubayda and 'Utba struggled with one another. Hamza and 'Ali then charged at 'Utba and got away with him. They defeated him and brought 'Ubayda back to their ranks for he had been badly injured. Later on 'Ubayda died due to excessive loss of blood. (Ibn Hisham, Vol. I, p. 625)

THE GENERAL ATTACK

The Quraish were now filled with a renewed fury. With a cry of rage, they darted and assailed the Muslim champions whereupon the Prophet cried, "Rise for the Paradise which breadth is equal to the heavens and the earth!"

THE FIRST MARTYR and THE AMBITION OF TWO BROTHERS

"Umayr b. al-Hunaim heard the Prophet's call and threw away the dates in his hand and ran to the battlefield and fought with the enemy until he was dead. He was the first martyr on the day of Badr. (Zad al-Ma'ad, Vol. I, p. 345 and Ibn Hisham, Vol. II, p. 215) The two sons of 'Afra"⁽⁶⁾ killed Abu Jahl.

THE GREAT VICTORY

The day of Badr drew towards its close with the Muslims sensing and already assured of success whereas the infidels were being trampled in the dust. On this occasion the Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) paid homage to God, saying: "Praise be to Allah who fulfilled His promise, and helped His servant and alone routed all the enemies." That was exactly what had happened, for the Qur'an also says: "Allah had given you the victory at Badr, when you were contemptible. So observe your duty to Allah in order that you may be thankful." [Qur'an 3:123]

On the day of Badr, seventy infidels were slain and an equal number were taken captive. Casualties among the Muslims were fourteen, six belonging to the Muhajirin and eight to the Ansaar. (Ibn Kathir, Vol. II, p. 463)

EFFECTS OF BADR'S VICTORY

The Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) returned to Madeenah at the head of a victorious army. The enemies of Islam were appalled and disheartened by the victory at Badr. The Prophet's prestige soared in Madeenah and his influence extended over the surrounding district. A large number of persons who had been hesitant for so long from the place accepted the faith of the Prophet.

'Abdallah b. Rawaha gave the good news to the people and he enumerated the names of the Qurayshite nobles that accompanied the delegation as they found him singing song of joy; some took the news to be true while others were confounded.

The defeat suffered by the polytheists plunged Makkah into gloom. There was not a house in the city, which did not go into mourning. (Ibn Hisham, Vol. pp. 647-48). The Makkans stood aghast and agitated. Abu Sufyan swore that until he had fought with the Prophet again he would not take a bath. The suppressed Muslims of Makkah, on the other hand, breathed a sigh of relief and felt elated as well as vindicated.

TIES OF BLOOD OR FAITH

Of the captives was Abu 'Aziz b. 'Umayr. B. Hashim, a real brother of Mus'ab b. 'Umayr. The two brother were the standard bearers of the rival armies.

Mus'ab b. 'Umyr passed by his brother when an Ansaari young man was tying up the hands of Abu 'Aziz b. 'Umayr. Mus'ab called out, "Bind him fast, for his mother is sufficiently rich; perhaps she would pay a handsome ransom."

Turning to Mus'ab in amazement, Abu 'Aziz b. 'Umayr said, "Brother, is it you to give this counsel?" "You are not my brother", replied 'Umayr, "He is my brother who is tying up your hands."

TREATMENT OF THE CAPTIVES

The Prophet ordered his followers to treat the prisoners generously. The Muslims gave them bread for the morning and evening meals but they themselves took only dates as ordered by the Messenger of God. (Ibn Kathir, Vol. II, p. 475)

RANSOM OF THE PRISONERS

The Prophet accepted ransom for the prisoners according to their means. There were some prisoners who were unable to pay any ransom. But as they were literate they were allowed to earn their freedom by teaching the art of reading to the children of Ansaar, with ten children each for every prisoner available. (Musnad Ahmad b. Hanbal, Vol. I, p. 247) (Tabaqat Ibn S'ad, Vol. II, p. 14)

The reasons behind the success

The reasons behind the success can be outlined as follows:

1. UNITY OF LEADERSHIP: The Prophet was the supreme commander in the battle, an ideal leader who consulted with his companions, accepted good advices and went at the head of his forces when the need arose. This generated a magnificent discipline in the Muslim army, which is contrary to the deep divisions that characterize the armed forces of the enemies.

2. MILITARY COMPETENCE: The Muslim soldier was known for exemplary fighting competence, rigorous discipline, obedience to the commander and a strong communal spirit which the Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) had worked hard to inculcate in his companions. This was exemplified in the brotherhood between the Muhaajirun (Makkan Muslims) and the Ansaar (Madinan Muslims). On the opposite side, we see that extreme selfishness and individualism were dominant in the ranks of the Makkan pagan army.

3. NEW TROOP-DISPOSITION PLAN: The march of the Muslim army from Madeenah was in a combative form, which resembles modern fighting strategies. The Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) sent off a vanguard and left behind a rear-guard, made use of exploratory patrols, raided the enemy camps to take captives that divulge information before the battle and braved the war in a new fashion based on cooperation, that of fighting with closed ranks. On the other hand, the Makkan pagan army followed a hit-and-run approach.

4. HIGH SPIRITS: The Muslim fighter enjoyed high morale emanating from firm faith. The Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) encouraged his men and enhanced their spirits with constant prayers and promising them with success.

5. CLARITY OF PURPOSE: The chief purpose of the Muslims was to destroy the heads of infidelity and remove the obstacles from the way of the mission. Assaulting the caravan of Quraish was only a tactical aim. This is why we find that the Prophet (sallallahu `alayhi wa sallam) decided to attack the Makkan Pagan army to realize the strategic chief purpose mentioned earlier in spite of the fact that the caravan (the tactical aim) had slipped away.

6. HAVING A SUBLIME END: Muslims were fighting to attain God's pleasure, to raise God's word over all others and to remove material obstacles facing Islam which aims to liberate man from slavery and oppression. On the other side of the spectrum, the Pagans were fighting for lowly worldly aims, corrupt decrepit ideas or in fanatic support of a tribe or clan.

In brief we can see the results of the battle as follows:

- a. The battle put in jeopardy Makkah's trade route with the Syrian territories.
- b. It weakened Quraish's reputation and respect among Arabs.
- c. It solidified the Muslims' position and the status of their new nucleus state in Madeenah.
- d. It paved the way for spreading Islam among the tribes of Arabia by destroying the barrier of respect paid to Quraish which was defeated.
- e. It enhanced the solidarity between the Muhajirun and the Ansaar.
- f. It provided an occasion to pass as law the taking of a fifth of the spoils for the Muslim treasury. Quranic verses revealed immediately after the battle made this law which enhanced the Muslim treasury and the Muslim state budget. This law continued to be the greatest source of income for the treasury up to the end of the Muslim conquests in the early days of Islam.

http://www.a2youth.com/articles/history_and_biographies/the_battle_of_badr/3

5. The Battle of Uhud

Background of the Battle:

The idolaters suffered many casualties among their noble men at the battle of Badr. The caravan that Abu Sufyan led (before Badr) returned safely to Makkah, prompting the remaining Makkan leaders and the children of those who were killed at Badr to demand from Abu Sufyan to, “Spend this money on fighting Muhammad!” Consequently, they spent the money from the caravan on warfare expenses and mobilized their forces including the Ahabish tribes (tribes living around the city). He also forbade the mourning of the losses at Badr, for he was eager to exact revenge upon Muhammad, vowing to conduct a retaliatory raid on the city of Madina. Several months later, [Abu Sufyan](#) accompanied a party of 200 men to the city, obtaining temporary residence with the chief of the [Jewish](#) tribe [Banu Nadir](#) and learning more of the current situation in Madina. He and his party then left Madina, burning down two houses and laying waste to some fields in fulfillment of his vow. Further skirmishes between the Makkans and the Muslims would occur thereafter.

Makkan force sets out

The following year on March 11, 625, with Abu Sufyan at the helm, the Makkans—anxious to avenge their defeat at Badr—raised another force numbering 3,000 and set out for the Muslim base in Medina. Rather than attacking Medina itself, which was populated by numerous strongholds that would have required long sieges to overcome, they camped on the pastures north of the city, hoping that the Muslims would come out to meet them. According to the early Muslim historian [Ibn Ishaq](#), a number of Makkan women are said to have accompanied Abu Sufyan’s army to provide vocal support, including [Hind bint Utbah](#), his wife. The Quraysh mobilized their forces of three thousand men with two hundred horsemen on each flank. They appointed Khalid bin Al-Walid to lead the right side of the horsemen and ‘Ikrimah Ibn Abi Jahl on the left side. They also gave their grand flag to the tribe of Bani ‘Abd Ad-Dar.

Preparation of Muslim Army

The Messenger of Allah led the Friday prayer and when he finished with it, he performed the funeral prayer for a man from Bani An-Najjar called Malik bin ‘Amr. The Prophet then asked the Muslims for advice, if they should march to meet the disbelievers, or fortify themselves in Al-Madinah. ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy (the chief hypocrite) advised that they should remain in Al-Madinah, saying that if the disbelievers lay siege to Al-Madinah, the siege would be greatly disadvantageous to them. He added that if they decide to attack Al-Madinah, its men would face off with them, while women and children could throw rocks at them from above their heads; and if they decide to return to Makkah, they would return with failure. However, some companions who did not attend the battle of Badr advised that the Muslims should go out to Uhud to meet the disbelievers. The Messenger of Allah went to his home, put on his shield and came out. The companions were weary then and said to each other, “Did we compel the Messenger of Allah to go out” They said, “O Messenger of Allah! If you wish, we will remain in Al-Madinah.” The Messenger of Allah said: It is not for a Prophet to wear his shield for war then lay down his arms before Allah decides in his favor. The Messenger of Allah marched with a thousand of his Companions. When they reached the Shawt area, ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy went back to Al-Madinah with a third of the army, claiming he was angry the Prophet did not listen to his advice. He and his supporters said, “If we knew that you would fight today, we would have accompanied you.

However, we do not think that you will fight today.” The Messenger of Allah marched until he reached the hillside in the area of Uhud, where they camped in the valley with Mount Uhud behind them.

The Messenger prepared his forces for battle, and his army was seven hundred men. He appointed ‘Abdullah bin Jubayr, from Bani ‘Amr bin ‘Awf, to lead the archers who were fifty men. The Prophet said to them: “Keep the horsemen away from us, and be aware that we might be attacked from your direction. If victory was for or against us, remain in your positions. And even if you see us being picked up by birds, do not abandon your positions.” This was a strategic decision in order to shield the vulnerable flanks of the outnumbered Muslim army; the archers on the hill were to protect the left flank, while the right flank was to be protected by the Mount of Uhud situated on the east side of the Muslim camp.

The Prophet wore two protective shields and gave the flag to Mus’ab bin ‘Umayr of Bani ‘Abd Ad-Dar.

Encounter at Uhud

The Makkans attacked with their initial charge led by the Madinan exile Abu ‘Amir. But Abu ‘Amir and his men were forced to retire and tend to the camps behind the Makkan lines. Then a Makkan, Talhah ibn Abi Talhah al-‘Abdari, challenged the Muslims to a [duel](#). [Ali](#) ibn Abi Talib struck him down in a single blow. Talhah’s brother, ‘Uthman, ran forward to pick up the fallen banner and [Hamza \(R.A.\)](#) emerged from the Muslim ranks, bringing him to a similar fate as Talhah. In this same way, Talhah’s brothers and sons went to retrieve the Makkan banner and fight unsuccessfully, until they all eventually perished.

Following the duels, general engagement between the two armies commenced. The Makkan army was pushed back. Enjoying the best of these early encounters, the Muslims pierced through the Makkan lines, with victory appearing certain. However, it was the detachment of the Muslim archers, disobeying Prophet’s strict orders to remain stationary, that would shift the outcome of the battle, as they ran downhill to join in the advance and despoil the Makkan camp, leaving the flank vulnerable.

At this critical juncture, the Makkan cavalry led by Khalid ibn al-Walid exploited this move and attacked the remaining minority of Muslim archers who refused to disobey Muhammad’s orders. From there, the Makkans were then able to target and overrun the Muslim flank and rear. Confusion ensued, and numerous Muslims were killed. Hamza had been thrown down in a surprise attack by the [Ethiopian](#) slave of Hind, [Wahshi ibn Harb](#). Muhammad had been wounded due to missiles of stone which resulted in a gash on his forehead and lip.

After fierce hand-to-hand combat, most of the Muslims managed to withdraw and regroup higher up on the slopes of Uhud. Hind and her companions are said to have mutilated the Muslim corpses, cutting off their ears and noses and making the relics into anklets. Hind is reported to have cut open the corpse of Hamza, taking out his liver which she then attempted to eat.

Result of the Battle:

Nearly 70 prominent early Muslims were killed in the Battle of Uhud, including Hamza bin Abdul-Mutallib, Musab ibn Umayr (may Allah be pleased with them). Abu Sufyan, after some brief verbal exchanges with Muhammad’s companion, [Umar](#) (Umar ibn al-Khattab), decided to return to Mecca without pressing his advantage. The battle is generally believed by scholars to be a defeat for the Muslims, as they had incurred greater losses than the Makkans. However, most of scholars said that the Makkan victory was not complete. They were not able to achieve their ultimate aim, which was to

destroy the Muslims once and for all. Rather than feeling demoralized, the Muslims found inspiration in the Quran and reinforced their commitment. The two armies would meet again at the Battle of the Trench two years later.

The reasons for the setback at Uhud

Before explaining the reasons for this setback, it should be pointed out that the Companions, after the Prophets, are superior to everybody else in virtue. They are honored with being the comrades and trainees of Prophet Muhammad, the greatest of creation, the one for whose sake the universe was created and who was sent as a mercy for all the worlds. Therefore, according to the rule “the greater the blessing, the greater the responsibility,” they had to be the most obedient to God and His Messenger.

We read, for example, whoever of the Prophet’s wives commits manifest indecency, the punishment for her will be doubled ... you are not like any other women (33:30, 32). Likewise, even a small sin committed by a Companion deserves severe punishment. They are all included in those “foremost in belief and nearness to God,” and their conduct is an example to be followed by later generations. Therefore, they must be pure in belief and intention, sincere in worship and devotion, upright in conduct, and extremely careful in refraining from sin and disobedience. God raised the community of Muhammad as the best community to enjoin the good and forbid the evil, and believe in One God (3:110) and appointed them as a middle nation so that they may be witnesses to humanity, and the Messenger may be a witness to them (2:143). In the early years of the Madinan era, the Companions consisted of true believers and Hypocrites. Therefore, God wanted to sift His true witnesses against all humanity, and see who strove hard in His Way and remained steadfast (3:141-42). The Battle of Uhud, therefore, was a decisive test to sift out the sincere and steadfast from the hypocritical and wavering, and served to make the Islamic community more stable and formidable. After these preliminary notes, we can summarize why the Muslims experienced a setback as follows:

- The Messenger, the commander-in-chief, thought they should stay within Madina. The younger Companions, inexperienced and excited, urged him to march out of the city. This was a mistake, even though for the sake of martyrdom in the way of God, since the Messenger tended to apply different tactics in battles and knew in advance that the Quraysh army was coming to fight in open field. The archers posted to defend the army left their posts. They misinterpreted the Messenger’s order not to leave for any reason and went to collect booty.
- The 300 Hypocrites, one-third of the army, deserted half-way and returned to Madina. This undermined the morale of the Banu Salama and Banu Haritha tribes, who were persuaded only with difficulty not to leave. Moreover, a small group of Hypocrites demoralized the Muslims during the battle.
- Several Companions became impatient. They acted, in certain respects, inconsistently with the dictates of piety and were lured by material wealth.
- Some believers thought that as long as the Messenger was with them, and as long as they enjoyed God’s support and help, the unbelievers could never beat them. However true this was, the setback taught them that deserving God’s help requires, besides belief and devotion, deliberation, strategy, and steadfastness. They also perceived that the world is a field of testing and trial:

Many ways of life and systems have passed away before you; journey in the land, and see the end of those who did deny (the Messengers). This is an exposition for humanity, and a guidance and an admonition for the Godfearing. Don't faint or grieve, for you shall gain mastery if you are true believers. If a wound has touched you, a like wound already touched the (unbelieving) people (at Badr); such days We deal out in turn among humanity, that God may see who are the believers, and that He may take witnesses from among you; God loves not the evildoers; and that God may prove the believers, and blot out the unbelievers. (3:137-41)

- Those who had not taken part in Badr sincerely prayed to God for martyrdom. They were deeply devoted to Islam and longed to meet God. Some, like 'Abd Allah ibn Jahsh,

Anas ibn Nadr, Sa'd ibn Rabi', 'Amr ibn Jamuh, and Abu Sa'd Haysama tasted the pleasure of martyrdom; the martyrdom of the others was delayed. The Qur'an sings the praises of them as follows:

Among the believers are men who were true to their covenant with God; some of them have fulfilled their vow by death (in battle), and some are still awaiting, and they have not changed in the least. (33:23)

- Any success or triumph lies with God, Who does whatever He wills and cannot be questioned. Belief in God's Unity means that believers must always ascribe their accomplishments to God and never appropriate anything good for themselves. If the decisive victory of Badr gave some Muslims a sort of self-pride, and if they imputed the victory to their own prudence, wise arrangement, or some material causes, this would have been part of the reason for their setback.

- Among the Qurayshi army were several eminent soldiers and commanders (such as Khalid ibn Walid, Ikrima ibn Abi Jahl, 'Amr ibn al-'As, and Ibn Hisham) who were destined by God to be great servants of Islam in the future. They were the ones most esteemed and respected among the people. For the sake of their future service, God may not have willed to hurt their feelings of honor completely. So, as expressed by Bediuzzaman Said Nursi, the Companions of the future defeated the Companions of the present.

- The following verses explain the reasons for that setback together with its aftermath, and the lessons to be taken from it:

Did you suppose you should enter Paradise without God displaying which of you have struggled and who are patient? (3:142) Muhammad is naught but a Messenger; Messengers have passed away before him. Will you, if he should die or is slain, turn back on your heels? Whoever should turn back on his heels will not harm God in any way;

Lessons from the Battle of Uhud

In his book, *Zad al-Ma'ad*, Ibn al-Qayyim cited many of the rulings and noble lessons derived from the battle of Uhud, among them:

1. The believers learned the negative consequence of disobedience, loss of courage and dispute, and that what occurred was the result of it. As Allah (Almighty) said: And Allah had certainly fulfilled His promise to you when you were killing them, with His permission, until when you

lost courage and fell to disputing about the [Prophet's] order and disobeyed after He had shown you that which you love. Among you are some who desire this world, and among you are some who desire the Hereafter. Then He turned you back from them [defeated] that He might test you. And He has forgiven you. (3:152) When they experienced the consequence of their disobedience to the Messenger (Peace and blessings of Allah upon him), their weakening and their arguments, they became more careful and aware thereafter.

2. Allah's wisdom and method required that His messengers and their followers triumphed at times and are defeated at times, but the outcome was always in their favour. Because if they were continually victorious, non-believers as well as believers would join them, so believers could not be distinguished from others.
3. Sincere believers were distinguished from hypocrites, for when Allah(Almighty) gave the Muslims victory over their enemies on the day of Badr some entered Islam whose motives were not as they appeared. So, the wisdom of Allah(Almighty) necessitated a test to differentiate between the believer and the hypocrite. In this battle, the hypocrites showed their true colours and spoke of what they had previously concealed. So, the believers realized that they had an enemy from within and thus could be cautious of them and prepared for them.
4. Allah(Almighty) tests His servants in both good times and bad through that which they like and which they dislike, in victory and defeat. When they show firm obedience and servitude in what they like and what they dislike, then they are true servants of his.
5. If Allah(Almighty) had always given them victory in every circumstance and had always subdued their enemies, they would have become oppressive and arrogant. His servants are only kept righteous and balanced through good times and bad, hardship and ease.
6. When Allah(Almighty) afflicts them with setbacks, loss and defeat, they become humble and submissive, making them deserving of His might and victory.
7. Allah(Almighty) has prepared for His believing servants positions in His Paradise which they cannot reach through their deeds; they will reach them only through difficulties and trials. So, He gives them the means to reach those positions in the form of problems and ordeals.
8. When enjoying continuous health, wealth and ascendancy, human souls acquire an oppressive and impatient nature. This is a disease that hinders one on his journey to Allah(Almighty) and the Hereafter. So, when Allah(Almighty) intends to honour a soul, He gives it difficulties and hardships which serve as treatment for that disease, like a doctor who makes a patient drink a bitter medicine or removes diseased parts from him. And if he left him to his own wishes and inclinations, they would destroy him.
9. Martyrdom in the sight of Allah(Almighty) is among the highest ranks earned by His allies. The martyrs are His privileged servants who are nearest to Him. In fact, after the rank of siddeeq (the intimate and fervent supporter of a prophet) comes that of the shaheed (martyr). The only way to attain this rank is through the circumstances leading to it, i.e., being overcome by an enemy.
10. When Allah(Almighty) intends to destroy His enemies he provides them with the causes of their destruction. The greatest of these causes after unbelief is their oppression, tyranny and abuse of His sincere allies, their waging war against them and overpowering them. In this way, He(Almighty) purifies His servants of their sins and faults. And thereby, He increases the causes of His enemies' destruction

6. The Battle of Ahzab/ Trench/ Ditch/ Confederates

It is one of the famous battles of our beloved Messenger Muhammad (S. A. W.), the battle of Ahzab. Allah (S. W.T) chose this name for a *Surah* (chapter) in the Qur'an. This battle was against an unholy alliance or coalition not too dissimilar to the one we face today. The term "Ahzab" in Arabic means alliance, confederates or coalition. This battle is also known as the battle of Khandaq (the trench).

Background to the Battle

After the battle of Uhud there were no less than eight battles. After this there was a period of relative calm for approximately one year. However, the Jews whose treachery and intrigues had made them taste all kinds of humiliation and disgrace had still not learnt their lesson. After they had been exiled to Khaybar, they remained waiting anxiously for the results of the battles taking place between the Muslims and the Mushrikeen.

Twenty chiefs of the Jews with some of the influential of Banu Nadir went to Makkah to negotiate an unholy alliance with Quraish. They began to goad the people there to attack the Messenger of Allah (S. A. W.) promising them full support and backing. However the Quraish felt hesitation to prepare them against the Prophet. Therefore, the Jews delegation endeavored to incite the Arabs against the Messenger of Allah in order to exact their revenge for being expelled from Madinah. They also said Banu Nadir, are waiting for you to march with them against Muhammad and his companions, and Banu remained in Madinah to deceive Muhammad. The Jews assured them that their (Quraish) religion is better than Islam. The same delegation set out for Ghatafan, called them to do the same, and they responded positively. The Jewish delegation then started a fresh effort and toured some parts of Arabia and managed to incite a confederation of disbelief against the Prophet. Quraish, Kinanah and other allies from Tihama, in the south, rallied, ranked and recruited four thousand men under the leadership of Abu Sufyan. From the east there came tribes of Banu Saleem, Ghatafan, Bani Murrah, etc. They all headed for Madinah and gathered in its vicinity at a time already agreed upon. It was a great army of ten thousand fighters. They in fact outnumbered all the Muslims in Madinah, women, children and elders included. In reality if they had launched a surprise attack against Madinah, they could have exterminated all the Muslims.

The Digging of the Trench

The Messenger of Allah as the ruler of the Muslims summoned an advisory committee and conducted a careful discussion of a plan to defend Madinah. After a lengthy talk between military leaders and people who possessed sound advice, they agreed on the proposal of one of the honorable Sahabah, Salman Al-Farsi, to dig trenches as defensive lines. The northern part of Madinah was the most vulnerable, all the other sides being surrounded by mountains and palm tree orchards - the Prophet (S. A. W.) understood that the alliance (Ahzab) would march in that direction, so the trench was ordered to be on that side. The Muslims, with the Prophet, started to build a trench around Madinah. Severe hunger, bordering on starvation, could not dissuade or discourage them from achieving their desperately sought objective.

Miraculous Events

The Muslims were digging this trench in starvation and the biting cold but Allah provided their Rizq. One Sahabah, called Jabir ibn Abdullah, asked the Prophet for permission to go home. Prophet (saw) also permitted him. Upon returning back to the Prophet he said, “O Messenger of Allah I have slaughtered a she-animal of ours and we have ground a Sa’a of barley...So please come, you and another person along with you.” The Prophet (saw) got up and shouted out to the men, “O people of the trench, Jabir has prepared a meal for us, so let’s go.” Consequently the Prophet with over one thousand companions arrived. He opened the cooking pot and invoked the blessings of Allah upon it. Then he told the people to eat and they ate until they were all completely full and yet the shoulder of mutton and dough that was being baked remained as they were undiminished. In another incident a woman brought a handful of dates and passed by the Prophet (Sallallahu Alaihi Wasallam), who took the dates, threw them over his cloak and invited his followers to eat. The dates began to increase in number until they dropped over the trim of his robe.

Sparks of Prophecy Al-Bara’ (ra) said, “On Al-Khandaq (the trench) Day there stood out a rock too immune for our spades to break up. We therefore went to see the Messenger of Allah for advice. He took the spade, and struck the rock uttering, ‘Bismillah, Allahu Akbar the keys of Ash-Sham (geographical Syria) are mine, I swear by Allah, I can see its palaces at the moment.’ On the second strike he said; ‘Allahu Akbar, Persia is mine, I swear by Allah, I can now see the white palace of Madain.’ And for the third time he struck the rock, which turned into very small pieces, he said; ‘Allah is Great, I have been given the keys of Yemen, I swear by Allah, I can see the gates of San’a while I am in my place’” [Ahmad & An-Nasai].

The Attack

The huge army of the Mushrikeen (idolaters) had arrived and settled in the vicinity of Madinah in places called Al-Asyal and Uhud. Three thousand Muslims, with Muhammad (S. A. W.) at their head, came out to encounter the idolaters, with Allah’s Promise of victory deeply established in their minds. They entrenched themselves in Sila’ Mountain with the trench standing as a barrier between them and the disbelievers. The Quraish were surprised to see a wide trench, a new stratagem unknown in Arabia before, standing as an obstinate obstruction. The army of the enemy tried day and night to cross the ditch, but every time they were faced with the furious attacks of the sentries as planned by the Prophet. Therefore they decided that a group of fighters led by ‘Amr bin ‘Abd-e-Wudd, ‘Ikrima bin Abi Jahl and Dirar bin Al-Khattab, should work its way through the trench. They did in fact manage to do that and their horsemen captured a marshy area between the trench and Sila’ Mountain. ‘Amr challenged the Muslims to a duel. Ali accepted the challenge and killed him and obliged the others to evacuate in a state of panic and confusion. However, some days later, the polytheists conducted fresh desperate attempts but all of them failed due to the Muslims’ steadfastness and heroic confrontation.

Missing of the Asr prayer

In the context of the events of the Battle of Ahzab, the Messenger of Allah failed to observe Asr prayer in its right time as Jabir (ra) narrated that the Prophet then went to Buthan, performed ablution and observed the afternoon prayer after the sun had set and then offered the sunset prayer after it.

The Treachery of Banu Qurayzah

The chief criminal of Banu Nadir, Huyai, managed to win Ka'b Asad Al-Qurazi, the chief of Banu Qurayzah who had drawn a pact with the Messenger of Allah and persuaded him to break his covenant. Banu Qurayzah then started to launch war operations against the Muslims especially the secluded garrisons that housed the women and children of the Muslims. Safiyah binte 'Abdul Mutallib took a bar of wood, went down and struck the Jew to death who was spotted lurking around their site. This event had discouraged the Jews from conducting further attacks thinking that those sites were protected by Muslim fighters. They, however, went on providing the idolaters with supplies in token of their support against the Muslims.

On hearing this bad news, the Messenger dispatched four Muslim prominent leaders Sa'd bin Mu'adh (ra), Sa'd bin 'Ubada (ra), 'Abdullah bin Rawaha (ra) and Khawat bin Jubair (ra) for investigation. They discovered that the news was true and that the Jews announced openly that no pact of alliance existed any longer. After being informed The Prophet said loudly: "Allah is Great! O Muslims! There are good tidings for you that victory is near". This sentence, which manifests the perfect bravery and sagacity of the great leader of Islam, was uttered to ensure that the morale of the Muslims might not be weakened on hearing about the violation of the pact by Bani Qurayzah. Then he immediately appointed two officers named Zayd Harithah and Maslamah Aslam along with five hundred soldiers to patrol the city and, while uttering *Takbir* (*Allaho Akbar*- Allah is Great!) prevent Bani Qurayzah from committing transgression so that the women and the children should feel comforted by hearing *Takbir*.

Response of the Hypocrites

The hypocrites began to sow the seeds of defeatism, and pretended to withdraw for the defence of their homes, though these were in no way exposed to danger. Allah (Subhnahu Wa ta'aala) then revealed: "And when the hypocrites and those in whose hearts is a disease said, 'Allah and His Messenger promised us nothing but delusions!' And when a party of them said: 'O people of Yathrib (Al-Madinah), there is no stand (possible) for you (against the enemy attack!) therefore go back!' And a band of them asked for permission of the Prophet saying: 'Truly, our homes lie open (to the enemy).' And they lay not open. They but wished to flee" [TMQ Al-Ahzab: 12-13].

Response of the Believers

According to Ibn Kathir twelve days went by without fighting; only the occasional shooting of arrows. When the condition pressed hard upon the people, the Prophet consulted with Sa'd bin Mu'adh and Sa'd bin 'Ubadah for reconciliation with the chiefs of Ghatafan on the basis of donating them a third of Madinah's fruit crops. Sa'd bin Mu'adh then said, "Allah has honored us with Islam, guided us to Him, and granted us dignity by believing in him and following you. How could we give them our money! By Allah we will give them nothing but swords (fighting) until Allah judges between us and them."

Hudhaifa's mission

On the night of the battle of Ahzab and the Muslims were gripped with a violent and severe cold. The Messenger of Allah said, 'The man who brings me news of the enemy shall be ranked with me in the

Day of Judgment by Allah, Most High.’ None responded to him. He said it again and again and all kept quiet, then he said, ‘Stand up, Hudhaifah bring me the news of the enemy and do nothing that may provoke them against me.’”

Hudhaifah walked over to the enemy camp and walked back he felt warm as if he was walking in a heated bath and gave the information to the Prophet and then he felt cold again.

The Victory

Prophet's encouragement

The Prophet was not negligent of strengthening the morale of the soldiers of Islam even for a moment and encouraged them with his stirring and impressive speeches, to defend the freedom of their faith.

Coldness and shortage of foodstuff threatening the Arab army

The biting winter of that year and the shortage of foodstuff and fodder were threatening the lives of the Arab army and their animals.

Different motives of Arab army and Jews

The motive of the Arab and the Jew armies for fighting against Islam was not one and the same. The Jews were afraid of the ever-increasing expansion of Islam, whereas Quraysh were motivated by their old enmity for Islam and the Muslims. As regards the tribes of Ghatfan and Fazarah and other tribes they had participated in this battle for the sake of the proceeds of Khayber which the Jews had promised them.

Dividing the Enemies against Themselves

While the people of Madinah suffered from fear and threat, Muhammad concentrated his thoughts on finding means of saving the community.

1. He therefore sent a messenger to Ghatafan with the promise of one third of the total crop of Madinah if they withdrew and went home. Actually, Ghatafan had joined in this venture simply in order to appease Huyyay ibn Akhtab and his other Jewish companions.
2. On the other hand, the Prophet sent Nu'aym ibn Mas'ud to the Banu Qurayzah, their old friend from pre-Islamic days whose conversion to Islam was not yet known to them. He reminded them his friendship and warned them as prophet's direction that their rallying to the side of Quraysh and Ghatafan against Muhammad was liable to bring disaster, especially since neither Quraysh nor Ghatafan were likely to continue the siege for long. Nothing would prevent Muhammad from inflicting upon them great harm. This made the Banu Qurayzah dissuade from their treacherous course. Nu'aym then proceeded to the Quraysh camp and there intimated to their leaders that the Banu Qurayzah had repented their violation and they were seeking to befriend Muhammad anew. Latter they might seize Quraish men and give them up to Muhammad. Nu'aym then proceeded to Ghatafan and there repeated the same offer and warning. His ruse worked, and the leaders of Quraysh, Banu Quraizah and Ghatafan found its proofs because they found them that they denied to fight against Muhammad while they called each other.

The Anger of Nature

On that same night a very strong wind blew and an extremely heavy rain fell. Thunder deafened the ears and the lightning was blinding. The storm was so wild that it swept the tents of the enemy off the ground and brought havoc to their camp. It struck fear into their hearts, and they believed that the Muslims were seizing this opportunity to launch their attack. Tulayhah ibn Khuwaylid and Abu Sufyan openly suggested the Makkans and their allies to flee for their lives. The armies Quraysh, Ghatafan and their allies prepared to withdraw and each man carried as little as his camel, horse, or shoulders could bear and began to move while the storm continued to rage. When the morning came, there was not one of them to be seen in the area. The Muslims returned to their homes in Madinah with the Prophet and gave praise and thanks to God for their escape from the travails of war.

Muslims victory

The battle of the Trench took place in the fifth year Hijri. The siege of Madinah started in Shawwal and ended in Dhul Qa'dah, i.e. it lasted for over a month. It was in fact a battle of nerves rather than of losses. No bitter fighting was recorded; nevertheless, it was one of the most decisive battles in the early history of Islam and proved beyond a shadow of doubt that no forces, however huge, could ever exterminate the nascent Islamic power growing steadily in Madinah. When Allāh obliged the Confederates to evacuate, His Messenger was in a position to confidently declare that thenceforth he would take the initiative in war and would not wait for the land of Islam to be invaded. [Sahih Al-Bukhari 2/590]

Lessons from The Battle of Ahzab

1. The Alliance had gathered around the Muslims all over the world, don't think that the battle of the trench has finished. *"O you who believe! Remember Allah(SWT)'s favour on you when all the forces came to you: We sent against them wind and soldiers who no one saw. Allah sees all that you did and will reward you for that."* [EMQ 33:9] We must reflect upon this and take lesson for the alliances against the Muslims today such as those in Iraq, Chechnya, Afghanistan, India, Palestine, Kashmir, Myanmar etc. These are all alliances of evil, battles of Islam against Kufr, of Haq against Baatil.
2. The attack will come from all directions ideological, economical, social etc. *"Behold! they came on you from above you and from below"*
3. The Believers will be tested. *"When all your concepts and ideas became confused and fear entered until your hearts reached your throats and you started to doubt (the victory)!"* [EMQ 33:10] *"In that situation were the Believers tested: they were shaken as by a tremendous shaking."* [EMQ 33:11]
4. There will always be Hypocrites in the Ummah. *"And behold! the Hypocrites and those with weak personalities will say: "what we have been promised will not happen!"* [EMQ 33:12] *"Behold! a party among them said: "Ye men of Yathrib! Ye cannot stand (the attack)! Therefore go back!" "And a band of them ask for leave of the Prophet saying "Truly our houses are bare and exposed" though they were not exposed: they intended nothing but to run away."* [EMQ 33:13] *"And if the enemy succeed they will be part of the fitnah (siding with the enemy against the Muslims)!"* [EMQ 33:14] *"And yet they had already promised before that they would not turn their backs and a covenant with Allah must (surely) be answered for."* [EMQ 33:15]
5. The Prophet's asking Nu'aym ibn Mas'ud, during the battle to spread confusion and create trouble, indicates that deceit in a war against our enemies is allowed, if it will lead to victory, and that every means that may lead to victory and to less bloodshed is acceptable according to Islam, apart from treachery and betrayal. This is the political and military wisdom of the Prophet and it does not

contradict the basic principles of Islamic morality, because the aim is to reduce the numbers of slain in war, which is a humane purpose.

6. The fact that the Prophet accepted the advice of Salman to dig the ditch, which was something that the Arabs had never heard of before, indicates that Islam does not see anything wrong with making use of the experience of other nations that may benefit the ummah and the Muslim society. Here the Prophet accepted this advice is indicative of his flexibility and readiness to accept the good things that other nations had.

The Qur'an called the Treaty of Hudaibiya 'a manifest victory': *Surely We have given you a manifest victory. (al-Fath, 48.1)*

It proved to be indeed a victory because:

- By this Treaty, the Quraysh, after many years of unrelenting conflict with Islam, at length recognized Islam as (what they thought) an equal power with themselves. In effect, they had given up their struggle without admitting it to themselves. Having seen the Makkans dealing with the Prophet, upon him be peace and blessings, as an equal, and as a ruler, a rising tide of converts flowed towards Madina from all quarters of Arabia.
- There were many among the Quraysh themselves, who would benefit from reflecting on the call of God's Messenger in a peaceful atmosphere. The Treaty of Hudaibiya gave them this opportunity and, as a result, some leading figures of the Quraysh such as Khalid ibn Walid, 'Amr ibn al-'As and 'Uthman ibn Talha, who were famous for their military and political skills, accepted Islam. 'Uthman ibn Talha used to keep the keys of the Ka'ba, and after the conquest of Makka, God's Messenger honoured him with the same task.
- The Quraysh used to regard the Ka'ba as belonging to themselves exclusively and no one except them was allowed to visit it without paying tribute. By not stipulating that the Muslims must pay tribute for their deferred pilgrimage the following year, the Quraysh unwittingly breached their monopoly of the Ka'ba. This awakened desert tribes to the fact that the Quraysh had no right to claim the exclusive ownership of the Ka'ba.
- There were at the time in Makka believing Muslims, men and women, and the faith of some of them was unknown to their brothers from Madina. Some of them were employed by God's Messenger as spies. Had a fight taken place in Makka, even though the Muslims had been successful, they might unwittingly have killed some of those Muslims, not known to them as Muslims, and thus suffered the anguish of shedding Muslim blood, and caused either the martyrdom or disclosure of the Prophet's spies. This was prevented by the Treaty. The Qur'an points to this fact:

It is He who restrained their hands from you, and your hands from them, in the hollow of Makka, after He made you victors over them. God sees the things you do. They are the ones who unbelieved, and banned you from the Holy Mosque, and hindered the sacrificial animals from reaching their place of sacrifice. If it had not been for certain believing men and believing women (in Makka) whom you knew not - lest you should trample them and thus incur guilt for them unknowingly; that God may admit into His Mercy whom He will - (if the believers and unbelievers) had been clearly separated, then We would have chastised the unbelievers among them with a painful chastisement. (Al-Fath, 48.24-5)

- The Prophet, upon him be peace and blessings, performed the minor pilgrimage the following year. The testimony of faith, declaring that there is no god but God, and Muhammad is the Messenger of God, rang out in the valley of Makka. The Quraysh, camped on the Hill of Abu

Qubays, heard it, a portent of the coming triumph of Islam. This was, in fact, God's fulfilling of the vision He vouchsafed to His Messenger, as pointed out in the Qur'an:

God has indeed fulfilled the vision He vouchsafed to His Messenger truly: You shall enter the Holy Mosque, if God wills, in security, your heads shaved, your hair cut short, not fearing. He knew what you knew not, and, granted, besides this, a nigh victory. (al-Fath, 48.27)

- The Treaty of Hdaybiya freed God's Messenger to deal with others. In the expeditions which followed the Treaty, the Muslims conquered the redoubtable citadels of the Jews of Khaybar, giving the Jews the choice of entering Islam or accepting the rule of Islam by paying a tribute in lieu of protection (*jizya*), thereby impressing their neighbors and the Arabs of the Peninsula with the growing strength of the Islamic state.

The Muslims faithfully observed the terms of the Treaty. But the Makkans later on broke the terms in the attack which one of their allied tribes (the Banu Bakr) made on the Banu Khuda'a (who were in alliance with the Prophet). So, in January 630, two years after the Treaty of Hdaybiya, at the head of an army of 10,000, God's Messenger, upon him be peace and blessings, marched upon Makka and conquered it, meeting almost no resistance. The Ka'ba was purified of idols and in the course of the following days, the Makkans accepted Islam. This was due to happen because,

It is He who has sent His Messenger with the guidance and the religion of truth, that He may uplift it above every religion. God suffices as a witness. Muhammad is the Messenger of God, and those who are with him are hard against the unbelievers, merciful to one another. You see them bowing, prostrating, seeking grace from God and (His) good pleasure. Their mark is on their faces, the trace of prostration. That is their likeness in the Torah, and their likeliness in the Gospel: as a seed that puts forth its shoot, and strengthens it, and it grows stout and rises straight upon its stalk, pleasing the sowers, that through them He may enrage the unbelievers. God has promised those of them who believe and do deeds of righteousness forgiveness and a mighty wage. (al-Fath, 48.28-9)

7. Treaty of Hdaybiyyah

The **Treaty of Hdaybiyyah** (Arabic: **صلح الحديبية**) was an important event that took place during the formation of Islam. It was a pivotal treaty between Muhammad, representing the state of Medina, and the Quraish tribe of Mecca in March 628 (corresponding to Dhu al-Qi'dah, 6 AH). It helped to decrease tension between the two cities, affirmed a 10-year peace, and authorized Muhammad's followers to return the following year in a peaceful pilgrimage, The First Pilgrimage.^{[1][2][3]}

Background

Muhammad, a Meccan, stated that from the age of 40, he was receiving revelations from God. He and his followers were persecuted by the other Meccans, primarily the powerful tribe of the Quraish, and eventually forced to flee to the city of Medina, 250 kilometres (160 mi) to the north. Armed hostilities ensued, at events such as the Battle of Badr and the Battle of the Trench.

Attempted pilgrimage

Muhammad had a dream that he entered Makkah and did tawaf around the Ka'bah. His Companions in Madinah were delighted when he told them about it. They all revered Makkah and the Ka'bah and they yearned to do tawaf there. In 628, Muhammad and a group of 1,400 Muslims marched peacefully towards Mecca, in an attempt to perform the Umrah (pilgrimage). They were dressed as pilgrims, and brought sacrificial animals, hoping that the Quraish would honor the Arabian custom of allowing converts to enter the city. The Muslims had left Medina in a state of *ihram*, a premeditated spiritual and physical state which restricted their freedom of action and prohibited fighting. This, along with the paucity of arms carried, indicated that the pilgrimage was always intended to be peaceful.^[4]

Muhammad's people camped outside of Mecca, and Muhammad met with a Meccan emissary. He said:^[citation needed]

We have not come to fight anyone, but to perform the 'Umra. No doubt, the war has weakened Quraish and they have suffered great losses, so if they wish, I will conclude a truce with them, during which they should refrain from interfering between me and the people, and if I have victory over those infidels Quraish will have the option to embrace Islam as the other people do, if they wish; they will at least get strong enough to fight. But if they do not accept the truce, by Allah in Whose Hands my life is, I will fight with them defending my Cause till I get killed, but (I am sure) Allah will definitely make His Cause victorious.

The two parties decided to resolve the matter through diplomacy rather than warfare, and a treaty was drawn up.

The Quraysh realizing their mistake and the risk of losing important allies, came to an agreement with the Prophet. The terms of the treaty were written down and is known as the "**Treaty of Hudaibiyah.**" It included:

"In your name, O Allah. These are the terms of the truce between Muhammad, the son of Abdullah and Suhayl, the son of Amr (of Mecca).

1. The Muslims shall return this time and come back next year, but they shall not stay in Makkah for more than three days.
2. They shall not come back armed but can bring with them swords only sheathed in scabbards and these shall be kept in bags.
3. War activities shall be suspended for ten years, during which both parties will live in full security and neither will raise sword against the other.
4. If anyone from Quraish goes over to Muhammad [pbuh] without his guardian's permission, he should be sent back to Quraish, but should any of Muhammad's followers return to Quraish, he shall not be sent back.
5. Whosoever wishes to join Muhammad [pbuh], or enter into treaty with him, should have the liberty to do so; and likewise whosoever wishes to join Quraish, or enter into treaty with them, should be allowed to do so.

Al-Hudaibiyah Treaty: Socio-political Impact

A series of events confirmed the profound wisdom and splendid results of the peace treaty which Allâh called "a manifest victory". How could it be otherwise when Quraish had recognized the legitimate Muslims' existence on the scene of political life in Arabia, and began to deal with the believers on equal terms. Quraish in the light of the articles of the treaty, had indirectly relinquished its claim to religious leadership, and admitted that they were no longer interested in people other than Quraish, and washed their hands of any sort of intervention in the religious future of the Arabian Peninsula. The Muslims did not have in mind to seize people's property or kill them through bloody wars, nor did they ever think of pursuing any coercive approaches in their endeavours to propagate Islam, on the contrary, their sole target was to provide an atmosphere of freedom as regards ideology or religion:

"Then whosoever wills, let him believe, and whosoever wills, let him disbelieve." [Al-Qur'an 18:29]

The Muslims, on the other hand, had the opportunity to spread Islam over areas not then explored. When there was armistice, war was abolished, and men met and consulted together, none talked about Islam intelligently without entering it; within the two years following the conclusion of the treaty double as many entered Islam as ever before. This is supported by the fact that the Prophet [pbuh] went out to Al-Hudaibiyah with only 1,400 men, but when he set out to liberate Makkah, two years later, he had 10,000 men with him.

The article of the treaty pertaining to cessation of hostilities for ten years points directly to the utter failure of political haughtiness exercised by Quraish and its allies, and functions as evidence of the collapse and impotence of the war instigator.

Quraish had been obliged to lose those advantages in return for one seemingly in its favour but does not actually bear any harm against the Muslims, i.e., the article that speaks of handing over believing men who seek refuge with the Muslims without their guardians' consent to Quraish. At first glance, it was a most distressing clause and was considered objectionable in the Muslim camp. However, in the course of events, it proved to be a great blessing. The Muslims sent back to Makkah were not likely to renounce the blessings of Islam; contrariwise, those very Muslims turned out to be centres of influence for Islam. It was impossible to think that they would become apostates or renegades. The wisdom behind this truce assumed its full dimensions in some subsequent events. After the Prophet [pbuh] had reached Madinah, Abu Baseer, who had escaped from Quraish, came to him as a Muslim; Quraish sent two men demanding his return, so the Prophet [pbuh] handed him over to them. On the way to Makkah, Abu Baseer managed to kill one of them, and the other one fled to Madinah with Abu Baseer in pursuit. When he reached the Prophet [pbuh], he said, "Your obligation is over and Allâh has freed you from it. You duly handed me over to the men, and Allâh has rescued me from them." The Prophet [pbuh] said, "Woe is his mother, he would have kindled a war if there had been others with him." When he heard that, he knew that he would be handed back to them, so he fled from Madinah and went as far as Saif Al-Bahr. The other Muslims who were oppressed in Makkah began to escape to Abu Baseer. He was joined by Abu Jandal and others until a fair-sized colony was formed and soon sought revenge on Quraish and started to intercept their caravans. The pagans of Makkah finding themselves unable to control those exiled colonists, begged the Prophet [pbuh] to do away with the clause which governed the extradition. They implored him by Allâh and by their ties of kinship to send for the group, saying that whoever joined the Muslims in Madinah would be safe from them. So the Prophet [pbuh] sent for the group and they responded, as expected, positively.

These are the realities of the clauses of the truce treaty and as it seems they all function in favour of the nascent Islamic state. However, two points in the treaty made it distasteful to some Muslims, namely they were not given access to the Holy Sanctuary that year, and the seemingly humiliating attitude as regards reconciliation with the pagans of Quraish. 'Umar, unable to contain himself for the distress taking full grasp of his heart, went to the Prophet [pbuh] and said: "Aren't you the true Messenger of Allâh?" The Prophet [pbuh] replied calmly, "Why not?" 'Umar again spoke and asked: "Aren't we on the path of righteousness and our enemies in the wrong?" Without showing any resentment, the Prophet [pbuh] replied that it was so. On getting this reply he further urged: "Then we should not suffer any humiliation in the matter of Faith." The Prophet [pbuh] was unruffled and with perfect confidence said: "I am the true Messenger of Allâh, I never disobey Him, He shall help me." "Did you not tell us," rejoined 'Umar, "that we shall perform pilgrimage?" "But I have never told you," replied the Prophet [pbuh], "that we shall do so this very year." 'Umar was silenced. But his mind was disturbed. He went to Abu Bakr and expressed his feelings before him. Abu Bakr who had never been in doubt as regards the Prophet's truthfulness and veracity confirmed what the Prophet [pbuh] had told him. In due course the Chapter of Victory (48th) was revealed saying:

"Verily, We have given you (O Muhammad [pbuh]) a manifest victory." [Al-Qur'an 48:1]

The Messenger of Allâh [pbuh] summoned 'Umar and imported to him the happy tidings. 'Umar was overjoyed, and greatly regretted his former attitude. He used to spend in charity, observe fasting and prayer and free as many slaves as possible in expiation for that reckless attitude he had assumed. [Fath Al-Bari 7/439-458; Sahih Al-Bukhari 1/378-381]

The early part of the year 7 A.H. witnessed the Islamization of three prominent men of Makkah, 'Amr bin Al-'As, Khalid bin Al-Waleed and 'Uthman bin Talhah. On their arrival and entrance into the fold of Islam, the Prophet [pbuh] said, "Quraish has given us its own blood."

A Manifest Victory: The Treaty of Hdaybiya

by Fethullah Gülen on 24 December 2002. Posted in [The Messenger of God: Muhammad](#)

User Rating: / 0

Poor ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☒ Best

The Messenger was a man of action. He never hesitated about putting his plans or decisions into action, for that would confuse and demoralize his followers. The Messenger always acted with deliberation and consulted others. But once he had decided or planned something, he carried it out immediately and had no second thoughts or a reason to regret his decision. Before acting, he took the necessary precautions, considered the probabilities, and consulted available experts. The ensuing finality of his decisions was an important reason for his victories and why his Companions followed him so completely.

One event worthy of further elaboration is the Treaty of Hdaybiya. In 6 ah, the Messenger told his Companions that he had dreamed they would shortly enter the Holy Mosque in Makka in security, with their heads shaved or their hair cut short. His Companions, especially the Emigrants, were delighted. During that year, the Prophet set out for Makka with 1,500 unarmed men in pilgrim dress (ihram).

Informed of this event, the Quraysh armed themselves and the neighboring tribes to keep the Muslims out of Makka. They sent some 200 soldiers, led by Khalid ibn Walid and Ikrima ibn Abu Jahl, as far as Qura' al-Ghamim. Seeing the Muslims approaching, they returned to Makka to spread the news. When the Muslims reached Hdaybiya, about 12 miles from Makka, the Messenger told them to halt. Learning that there was a shortage of water, he threw an arrow down Hdaybiya's only well. Water began to gush and fill the well. Everyone drank some, performed wudu', and filled their water-skins. [1]

As the Makkans refused to let the Muslims enter Makka, the Messenger sent Budayl ibn Warqa, a man from the Khuda'a tribe (the Muslims' ally), to announce that the Muslims had come for pilgrimage and thus were unarmed. The Quraysh, in reply, sent 'Urwa ibn Mas'ud al-Thaqafi. While talking to the Messenger 'Urwa tried to grasp his beard, a sign of jesting. Mughira ibn Shu'ba struck his hand, saying he would cut it off if 'Urwa tried such a thing again, for his hand was impure.

Mughira was 'Urwa's cousin, and had accepted Islam about 2 months earlier. In fact, only a few months ago 'Urwa had paid the blood money for a crime Mughira had committed. How Islam had changed Mughira! The Companions' commitment to their cause and devotion to the Messenger shocked 'Urwa, who returned to the Quraysh and said: "I have visited Chosroes, Caesar, and the Negus. None of their subjects are so devoted to their rulers as his Companions are to Muhammad. I advise you not to struggle with him." [2]

The Quraysh did not heed his advice. Nor did they give a warm welcome to Kharash ibn Umayya, whom the Messenger sent after 'Urwa. Kharash was followed by 'Uthman ibn 'Affan, who had powerful relatives among the Quraysh. Although 'Uthman came to negotiate with the Makkans, they imprisoned him. When he did not return at the expected time, rumors circulated that he had been killed. At this point, the Prophet, sitting under a tree, took an oath from his Companions that they would hold together and fight to the death. He represented the absent 'Uthman by proxy in this oath. Only Jadd ibn Qays, who hid behind a camel, did not take it. The revelation that came on this occasion reads: God was well pleased with the believers when they were swearing allegiance to you under the tree, and He knew what was in their hearts, so He sent down peace of reassurance on them, and has rewarded them with a near victory (48:18).

In that moment of tension, a cloud of dust appeared in the distance. This turned out to be a Makkan delegation led by Suhayl ibn 'Amr. When the Messenger learned this, he took his name ("easiness") as a good omen and told his Companions: "The situation has eased." Eventually, the Quraysh agreed to a truce and the Treaty of Hudaibiya was concluded.

Under this treaty, the Prophet and his followers could make pilgrimage the following year, not this one, at which time the Makkans would vacate the city for 3 days. The treaty also stipulated a 10-year truce, that people or tribes could join or ally themselves with whoever they wished, and that Qurayshi subjects or dependents who defected to Madina would be returned. This last condition was not reciprocal, and thus was opposed in the Muslim camp. It shocked people like 'Umar, who questioned the Messenger about it. However, it really was of little importance. Muslims sent back to Makka were not likely to renounce Islam; on the contrary, they would be agents of change within Makka.

Just before the treaty was signed, Abu Jandal, Suhayl's son, arrived in chains and asked to join the Muslims. The Messenger had to return him to his father in tears. However, he whispered to him: "God will shortly save you and those of your like." [3]

Shortly after the treaty was signed, 'Utba ibn Asid (also known as Abu Basir) defected to Madina. The Quraysh sent two men to demand his return. On their way back to Makka, Abu Basir escaped, killed one man and wounded the other. The Messenger, citing the treaty's terms, did not allow him to stay in Madina. So he settled at Iyys, a place on the road from Makka to Syria. The Muslims held in Makka began to join Abu Basir. As this settlement grew, the Makkans perceived a potential threat to their trade route. This forced them to ask the Messenger to annul the relevant term and admit defecting Makkans to Madina.

The Qur'an called the Treaty of Hudaibiya "a manifest victory": We have given you a manifest victory (48:1). This proved true for several reasons, among them:

- By signing this treaty after years of conflict, the Quraysh admitted that the Muslims were their equals. In effect, they gave up their struggle but did not admit it to themselves. Seeing the Makkans deal with

the Prophet as an equal and a ruler, a rising tide of converts flowed toward Madina from all over Arabia.

- Many Qurayshis would benefit from the resulting peace by finally reflecting on what was going on. Such leading Qurayshis as Khalid ibn Walid, 'Amr ibn al-'As, and 'Uthman ibn Talha, all famous for their military and political skills, accepted Islam. 'Uthman was the person entrusted with the Ka'ba's keys, and after the conquest of Makka the Messenger honored him with the same task.
- The Quraysh used to regard the Ka'ba as their exclusive property, and made its visitors pay them a tribute. By not subjecting the Muslims' deferred pilgrimage to this condition, the Quraysh unwittingly ended their monopoly. The bedouin tribes now realized that the Quraysh had no right to claim exclusive ownership.
- At the time, there were Muslim men and women living in Makka. Not everyone in Madina knew who they were. Some were serving the Messenger as spies. Had a fight taken place in Makka, the victorious Muslim army might have killed some of them. This would have caused great personal anguish, as well as the martyrdom or identification of the Prophet's spies. The treaty prevented such a disaster.

The Qur'an points to this fact: He restrained their hands from you, and your hands from them, in the hollow of Makka, after He made you victors over them. God sees the things you do. They are the ones who disbelieved, and banned you from the Holy Mosque, and hindered the sacrificial animals from reaching their place of sacrifice. If it had not been for certain believing men and believing women (in Makka) whom you knew not—lest you should trample them and thus incur guilt for them unknowingly; that God may admit into His Mercy whom He will—(the believers and unbelievers) had been clearly separated, then We would have chastised the unbelievers among them with a painful chastisement (48:24–25).

- The Prophet performed the minor pilgrimage the following year. The assertion: "There is no god but God, and Muhammad is the Messenger of God," rang throughout Makka. The Quraysh, camped on Abu Qubays Hill, heard this portent of Islam's coming triumph. This was, in fact, God's fulfilling the vision He had given to His Messenger: God has indeed fulfilled the vision He vouchsafed to His Messenger: You shall enter the Holy Mosque, if God wills, in security, your heads shaved, your hair cut short, not fearing. He knew what you knew not, and, granted, besides this, a nigh victory (48:27).
- The treaty allowed the Messenger to deal with others. In the post-treaty expeditions, the Muslims conquered the formidable Jewish citadels of Khaybar, telling them either to convert or accept Muslim rule by paying tribute in lieu of protection (jizya). Their neighbours, as well as other Arab tribes, were impressed with the Islamic state's growing strength.

The Muslims faithfully observed the treaty's terms; however, a tribe allied to the Makkans did not. The Banu Bakr attacked the Banu Khuda'a, who were allied with the Prophet. So in December 629, the Messenger marched a 10,000-man army against Makka, and captured it with almost no resistance on the first day of the new year. The Ka'ba was purified of idols and, over the next couple of days, the Makkans accepted Islam. This was due to happen because:

He has sent His Messenger with the guidance and the religion of truth, that He may uplift it above every religion. God suffices as a witness. Muhammad is the Messenger of God, and those who are with him are hard against the unbelievers, merciful to one another. You see them bowing, prostrating, seeking grace from God and (His) good pleasure. Their mark is on their faces, the trace of prostration. That is their likeness in the Torah, and their likeness in the Gospel is: as a seed that puts forth its shoot,

and strengthens it, and it grows stout and rises straight upon its stalk, pleasing the sowers, that through them He may enrage the unbelievers. God has promised those of them who believe and do deeds of righteousness forgiveness and a mighty wage (48.28–29).

[1] Muslim, Hadith No.1834; Bukhari, 4:256.

[2] Bukhari, 3:180; Ibn Hanbal, 4:324; Tabari, 3:75.

[3] Ibn Hisham, 3:321–333; Ibn Kathir, 4:188-193.

[< Prev](#)

8. The Conquest of Makkah

THE CONQUEST OF MAKKAH – PREPARATIONS:

When Islam was well established in the hearts of the Muslims, Allah decided that the time had come for His Messenger(s.a.w.) and his community to enter Makkah. They would purify the Ka‘bah so that it would be a blessed place of guidance for the whole world. They would restore Makkah to its previous status and the sacred city would offer security for all people once again.

A BROKEN TREATY:

The Banu Bakr entered into an alliance with the Quraysh while the Banu Khuza‘ah entered into one with the Messenger (s.a.w.) of Allah according to provision of the Peace Treaty of Hudaibiyyah.

One night the Banu Bakr attacked the Banu Khuza‘ah by night when they were camped by a spring and killed some of their men. A skirmish developed and the Quraysh helped the Banu Bakr by providing weapons. Some Quraysh leaders also fought with the Banu Bakr secretly by night.

SEEKING HELP:

Amr ibn Salim al-Khuza‘i went to the Messenger of Allah in Madinah. He asked for help, saying that the Quraysh had violated the agreement. His tribe had been attacked at night, he maintained, and men had been killed in ruku and sajdah, while performing prayers.

When the aggrieved party sought justice from their Muslim allies, the Prophet [pbuh], as their leader, demanded an immediate redress for not only violating the treaty but also slaying men allied to him in the sanctified area. Three demands were made, the acceptance of any one of them was imperative:

- a. to pay blood money for the victims of Khuza‘ah,
- b. to terminate their alliance with Banu Bakr; or
- c. to consider the truce to have been nullified.

Their reply was impulsive and they ignored the likely consequences.

THE QURAYSH ATTEMPT TO RENEW THE TREATY AND ABU SUFYAN FAILS:

The Quraysh were so concerned about what they had done that they charged Abu Sufyan with the task of getting the treaty ratified. Abu Sufyan came to the Messenger of Allah in Madinah but the Prophet did not receive any answer. He met with his daughter Umm Habibah, the wife of the Prophet, Abu Bakr, Umar, Ali, Fatima but they all did not respond him at all .

MAKING READY:

The Messenger of Allah asked the Muslims to start preparing for an expedition but he asked them to keep it a secret. Later he announced that he was going to Makkah and ordered them to get ready. He left Madinah with ten thousand men in Ramadan 8 A.H. and advanced as far as Marr az-Zahran where they set up camp. Allah concealed this information from the Quraysh, so they waited in uncertainty.

ABU SUFYAN IBN HARB ACCEPTS ISLAM:

The Messenger of Allah was commanding the army and he ordered the campfires to be lit. Abu Sufyan ibn Harb, came to the Messenger of Allah with Al-Abbas Ibn ‘Abdul Muttlib. Then Abu Sufyan recited the articles of faith and became a Muslim.

THE AMNESTY:

The Messenger of Allah was generous in granting amnesty to everyone so that no one in Makkah need be killed that morning. Only those who courted danger ran any risk of losing their life. He declared, ‘Whoever enters the house of Abu Sufyan is safe. Whoever locks his door is safe. Whoever enters the Ka‘ba is safe.’ He told his army not to use arms against anyone when they entered Makkah unless they met opposition or resistance. He directed the army not to touch property or possessions belonging to the people of Makkah and nothing should be destroyed.

ABU SUFYAN’S INFLUENCE:

The Muslim squadrons passed by like a surging sea with the different tribes bearing their standards. Finally the Messenger of Allah passed by with his squadron in full, gleaming green armor. It was the regiment of the Muhajirun and the Ansar. Only their eyes were visible because of their armor. Abu Sufyan stood up and shouted at the top of his voice, ‘O men of the Quraysh! This is Muhammad with a force you cannot resist. He has ten thousand men of steel. He says that whoever enters my house will be safe.’ ‘And whoever locks himself indoors is safe and whoever enters the mosque is safe.’ So the people dispersed and went into their homes or into the mosque.

A HUMBLE VICTORY:

On the morning of Friday, 20 Ramadan, 8 A.H., the Messenger of Allah entered Makkah with his head bowed. When he realized the honor of the conquest Allah had bestowed upon him, he felt so humble before Allah that his chin almost touched the back of his camel. He was reciting Surat al-Fath as he rode into Makkah in victory. He raised the standard of justice, equality, and humility.

MERCY NOT SLAUGHTER:

The Messenger (sallallahu alaiyhi wassallam) of Allah, declared: ‘Today is a day of mercy and forgiveness when Allah will exalt the Quraysh and raise honour for the Ka‘bah.’

SMALL SKIRMISHES:

A small skirmish broke out between Safwan ibn Umayyah, ‘Ikrimah ibn Abi Jahl and Suhayl ibn Amr, who came up against the companions of Khalid ibn al-Walid. Twelve of the idol-worshippers were killed when they tried to stop the advance of the Muslim forces. The rest gave in without further

bloodshed. The Messenger of Allah had told his men when they entered Makkah, 'Do not fight anyone unless they attack you.'

PURIFYING THE HARAM:

The Messenger of Allah got down from his camel when everything had calmed down. He went to the Ka'bah first and performed tawaf. Around the Ka'bah were three hundred and sixty idols. With a stick he was carrying he began to push them over, saying, 'The truth has come and falsehood has vanished away. Falsehood is ever vanishing. (17: 81) 'The truth has come and falsehood originates not nor brings again.' (34: 49) The idols collapsed one by one, falling onto their faces. Pictures and statues were found in the Ka'bah and the Messenger of Allah ordered that they should also be destroyed.

A DAY OF PIETY:

Having performed tawaf, the Messenger of Allah called Uthman ibn Talhah who had the key of the Ka'bah. The doors were unlocked and he went in. When the Messenger of Allah came out of the Ka'bah, Ali ibn Abi Talib stood up holding the key of the Ka'bah in his hand. He said to the Messenger of Allah, 'Grant us the guardianship of the Ka'bah along with providing water for the pilgrims.' The Messenger asked, 'Where is Uthman ibn Talhah? Uthman was summoned and the Messenger said to him, 'Here is your key, Uthman. Today is a day of piety and good faith. Keep it forever as an inheritance. Only a tyrant would take it from you.'

ISLAM: TAWHID AND UNITY:

The Messenger of Allah opened the door of the Ka'bah. The Quraysh had filled the mosque, and were waiting in rows to see what he would do. Holding the door frame, he said:

There is no god but Allah alone. He has no partner. He has made good His promise. He has helped His servant and He alone has put all allies to flight. Every claim of privilege, property or bloodline are abolished by me today except for the custody of the Ka'bah and providing water for the pilgrims.

O people of the Quraysh ! Allah has abolished the haughtiness of the *Jahiliyyah* and its veneration of ancestors. People all spring from Adam, and Adam came from dust.' Then he recited this verse, 'O mankind, We have created you male and female, and appointed you races and tribes, that you may know one another. Surely the noblest among you in the sight of Allah is the most God-fearing of you. Allah is All-Knowing, All-Aware. (49: 13)

NO DISCRIMINATION:

In the meantime, Fatimah, a woman of the Banu Makhzum had been apprehended for theft. Her community went to Usamah ibn Zayd, hoping that he could persuade the Messenger of Allah to intercede on her behalf. The Messenger of Allah declared: By the One who holds my life in His hand, if Fatimah bint Muhammad, were to steal, I would have her hand cut off. Then he ordered that the woman's right hand be cut off. She genuinely repented of her sin and went on to marry and lead a normal life.

PAYING HOMAGE IN ISLAM:

A large crowd gathered in Makkah to accept Islam and to pay homage to the Messenger of Allah. He received them on Mount Safa where they took the oath of allegiance. They promised to obey Allah and His Messenger to the best of their ability. When the men had pledged their faith, the women took the oath, including Hind bint Utbah, the wife of Abu Sufyan.

REMOVING ALL VESTIGES OF IDOLWORSHIP:

The Messenger of Allah sent groups of his Companions to destroy the idols standing round the Ka'bah. All of the idols were broken including al-Lat, al-Uzza, and Manat. He sent a crier to announce in Makkah, 'Whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day should destroy any idol in his house.' He also sent representatives to the surrounding tribes telling them to destroy their idols.

SANCTUARY OF MAKKAH

Then the Messenger of Allah assembled the Muslims in Makkah and declared that the city would be a sanctuary forever. He said, 'It is not lawful for anyone who believes in Allah and the Hereafter to spill blood in the city nor to cut down a tree. It was not lawful for anyone before me nor shall it be lawful for anyone after me.'

OUTCOME OF THE CONQUEST OF MAKKAH:

The conquest of Makkah had a tremendous impact on the Arabs. It showed that Islam was the religion of Allah and paved the way for the whole of Arabia to accept the faith. From far and wide people came to pay their respects to the Messenger of Allah and to accept Islam at his hands. Allah spoke the truth: When comes the help of Allah and victory and you see people entering the religion of Allah in throngs (Surah al-Nasr 110: 1-2).

Lessons from the conquest of Makkah

The conquest of Makkah was one of the most important victories for Islam and Muslims. With this success, Allah the Almighty honored His Prophet in particular and the Muslims in general. It was followed by years of continuous *Da'wah* (calling to Islam) and *Jihaad* to convey the message of Islam. It marked a significant stage in Islamic *Da'wah*, as if the end of the mission of the Prophet in this worldly life was drawing near, and it was a new start for the succeeding generations to fulfill the mission of spreading the message of Islam to the whole world.

It is true to say that the conquest of Makkah has implications, benefits and lessons that are too numerous to be listed in a book, not to mention in an article such as this. It is thus sufficient here to mention some of the benefits and implications contained in this historical event so as to understand its significance in the history of Islam and its impact on the path of calling to Allah the Almighty.

The first benefit: In this event we can see the nature of the Prophet who had no room in his heart for grudges against those who had resisted and opposed him. After a struggle between him and them, that had lasted for twenty-one years, in which they had spared no effort to try to kill him and his followers and put an end to his call, when he finally overcame them and conquered the capital of the idolatry, he did no more than pray for forgiveness for them and set them free. No such thing had ever been done in history, but it was done by a noble Messenger who did not seek kingship or power, but rather Allah wanted him to be a guide and conqueror of hearts and minds. Hence he entered Makkah in humility, thanking Allah, not boasting and gloating as mighty conquerors do.

The Second: The Prophet did with the people of Makkah for Allah knew that the Arabs would be the ones to carry His Message to the world, so he kept the people of Makkah, who were the leaders of the Arabs, alive so that they could enter the religion of Allah, and then convey the message of guidance and light to other peoples, sacrificing themselves, their rest and their bodies to save peoples from their misguidance, and leading them forth from darkness into light.

The Third: It brought that blessed land out of the grip of *Shirk* (polytheism) to the shelter of *Tawheed* (monotheism). When the Prophet first entered Makkah, he smashed all the idols surrounding the *Ka'bah*, reiterating the Saying of Allah The Almighty (what means): *{And say: 'Truth has come, and falsehood has departed. Indeed is falsehood, [by nature], ever bound to depart'} [Quran 17:81]* And: *{Say: 'The truth has come, and falsehood can neither begin [anything] nor repeat [it]'} [Quran 34:49]*

After that, Bilaal ascended the *Ka'bah* and called the *Azhaan* (call for prayer) loud and clear so that his words echoed throughout Makkah. With this, he was announcing the end of the era of myths and *Shirk*, and the beginning of enlightenment and *Tawheed* (Islamic monotheism).

The Fourth: The conquest of Makkah removed the threat that the disbelievers had imposed on the weak Makkans, whether they were Muslims or those who wished to embrace Islam but feared the threat of Quraysh, and so was denied their right to choose the religion of truth. This conquest came to remove that threat, and enable them to embrace the religion of Allah the Almighty without any fear.

The Fifth: This great conquest destroyed Quraysh and eliminated the intimidation with which they had affected the hearts of the Arab tribes who deferred their acceptance of Islam until they saw the future of Quraysh - whether it be victory or defeat. In his *Saheeh*, Al-Bukhaari narrated on the authority of 'Amr ibn Salamah that the Arabs deferred their Islam until the conquest, saying, *"Wait! If Muhammad gains victory over them, then he is indeed a true Prophet."* When the conquest took place, every tribe took the initiative and embraced Islam.

The Sixth: The conquest of Makkah increased the faith of the believers in the promise of their Lord – the promise of entering the [Sacred] House and circumambulating it after the polytheists had prevented them from doing so. Allah The Almighty Says (what means): *{Certainly has Allah showed to His Messenger the vision in truth. You will surely enter Al-Masjid Al-Haraam, if Allah wills, in safety, with your heads shaved and [hair] shortened, not fearing [anyone]} [Quran 48:27]*

The Seventh: the Muslims attained the honor of guarding and serving the House. This enabled them to reach the same high rank as the Quraysh had previously occupied among the Arabs – in fact, even higher.

The Eitght: the conquest of Makkah shook the center of disbelief and *Shirk* throughout the Arabian Peninsula and forced disbelieving leaders to fight on fronts that were weak and baseless, such as Thaqeef and Hawaazin about whom the Arabs did not care. After just two or three rounds of fighting, the whole Arabian Peninsula submitted to Islamic rule and turned into a center for disseminating the new religion. The conquering Muslim armies hastened to overthrow Chosroes and Caesar, and subjugate the two greatest and most oppressive empires to Islamic rule.

The Ninth: the conquest of Makkah unveiled a very significant truth: the attitude of the Prophet towards the people of Makkah who had shown enmity towards him from the very beginning of his *Da‘wah*. When Allah the Almighty honored him with entering Makkah, he turned to the Makkans and asked them what they expected him to do with them. They said: *“You are a generous brother, and the son of a generous brother.”* The Prophet said to them: *“Go, for you are free.”* [Al-Bayhaqi] With these simple words, the Prophet showed his noble attitude that was indeed most befitting for the person who had been sent by Allah the Almighty as a mercy for all the worlds.

These are just some of the benefits of the conquest of Makkah. Indeed, this event is unprecedented in its rank and importance to the extent that scholars called it the ‘Great Conquest’. That is because the greatest area on earth was relieved from the grip of *Shirk*, and was granted the safety of *Tawheed*. This is a truly remarkable result and a blessed conquest that led to a huge number of people entering the religion of Allah The Almighty who Says (what means): *{When the victory of Allah has come and the conquest, and you see the people entering into the religion of Allah in multitudes, then exalt [Him] with praise of your Lord and ask forgiveness of Him. Indeed, He is ever Accepting of repentance}* [Quran 110:1-3]

The Tenth: The final lesson that we learn from this victory that Islam achieved in an unimaginably short period of time. This is one of the greatest signs that Muhammad was indeed the Messenger of Allah and that Islam is the call to Allah Who guarantees that Islam and the believers who carry its banner will prevail. Allah would not forsake His call which is truth, mercy and light.

9. The Prophet (s.a.w.) and Jews

At the beginning of the seventh century A.D., there were three Jewish tribes living in Madina (Yathrib). They were Banu Qainuka’a, Banu Nadhir and Banu Qurayza. All three tribes were rich and powerful, and also, they were more civilized than the Arabs. Whereas the Arabs were all farmers, the Jews were the entrepreneurs of industry, business and commerce in Arabia, and they controlled the economic life of Madina (Yathrib). Besides Madina, the strong centers of the Jews in Hijaz were Khyber, Fadak and Wadi-ul-Qura. The lands in these valleys were the most fertile in all Arabia, and their Jewish cultivators were the best farmers in the country.

The migration of Muhammad from Makkah to Madina (then Yathrib), brought him into contact with the Jews for the first time. He made a treaty which offered security and assurance to those who agreed to adhere to it. The most important provisions of the treaty between the Muslims and Jews were the following:

1. The Jews of Bani ‘Awf are one community with the believers. The Jews will profess their religion and the Muslims theirs.
2. The Jews shall be responsible for their expenditure, and the Muslims for theirs.
3. If attacked by a third party, each shall come to the assistance of the other.
4. Each party shall hold counsel with the other. Mutual relation shall be founded on righteousness; sin is totally excluded.
5. Neither shall commit sins to the prejudice of the other.
6. The wronged party shall be aided.

7. The Jews shall contribute to the cost of war so long as they are fighting alongside the believers.
8. Madinah shall remain sacred and inviolable for all who join this treaty.
9. Should any disagreement arise between the signatories to this treaty, then God, the All-High and His Messenger shall settle the dispute.
10. The signatories to this treaty shall boycott Quraysh commercially; they shall also abstain from extending any support to them.
11. Each shall contribute to defending Madinah, in case of a foreign attack, in its respective area.
12. This treaty shall not hinder either party from seeking lawful revenge.

At the beginning they were friendly to him. He granted them the famous Charter of Madina, and they acknowledged him the ruler of their city, and agreed to abide by his decisions in all disputes. They also agreed to defend the city in the event of an invasion by an enemy. The Prophet tried his best to maintain friendly ties with the Jews. But, unfortunately, this friendship did not last long. They started a series of provocative and harmful deeds publicly. They tried to revive the rift between the tribes of Aws and Khazraj. They conspired with the *munaḥiqun* and sent emissaries to the enemies of Islam. Ka'b ibn Ashraf, Jewish chieftain of Banu Nadir, was a poet of considerable fame and fortune. Like so many others, he was bitterly hostile to Islam.

For this change in their attitude, there were many reasons, among them:

1. When Muhammad arrived in Madina, he reformed the life of the Arabs or whoever became a Muslim. He taught them to be temperate and moderate in everything, and taught them the value of discipline in life. They stopped drinking and gambling both of which were the causes of their ruin in the past; and they gave up taking loans at high rates of interest from the Jews. When the Arabs stopped taking loans and paying interest on them, a rich source of revenue suddenly dried up for the Jews, and they bitterly resented this. They could now see that their grip on the economic life of Madina was beginning to loosen.
2. The Jews also realized that Islam was an enemy of the system of exploitation, and of the capitalist system. They began to see Islam as a threat to their economic interests.
3. The Jewish priests hated Muhammad as much as the Jewish money-lenders. He had shown to the Jews how their priest followed deviant interpretations of their scriptures, and how they distorted their text. The priests, on their part, tried to convince their flocks that Muhammad did not have knowledge of their scriptures, and they tried to point out to them the "errors" in the Qur'an.
4. The Jews also believed that they were safe only as long as the two Arab tribes of Madina, the Aus and the Khazraj, were fighting against each other. Peace between the Aus and the Khazraj, they thought, would pose a threat to their survival in Arabia. For this reason, they were always fomenting trouble between them.

The Tribe of Banu Qaynuqa'

The most wicked amongst Jews were the tribe of Banu Qaynuqa', who lived in quarters within Madinah named after them. As for jobs, they took up goldsmithery, blacksmithing and crafts of making household instruments, that is why war weaponry was available in large quantities in their houses. They counted 700 warriors, and were the most daring and now the first to breach the covenant. They started a process of trouble-making, jeering at the Muslims, and even intimidating their women. Such things began to aggravate the general situation, so the Prophet [pbuh] gathered them in

assemblage, admonished and called them to be rational, sensible and guided and cautioned against further transgression. Nevertheless they remained obdurate and paid no heed to his warning. Their position amounted, as seen, to war declaration. The Prophet [pbuh] suppressed his anger and advised the Muslims to be patient. However, The Jews, went too far in their transgression, presumptuous behavior and licentious practices. One day a Jewish goldsmith provoked a Muslim woman whose genitals become uncovered when he had tied the edge of the garment to her back. A Muslim man happened to be there and killed the man; the Jews retaliated by killing that Muslim. The man's family called the Muslims for help and war started. [Ibn Hisham 2/47,48]

On Saturday, Shawwal 15th, 2 A.H., the Prophet [pbuh] marched out with his soldiers, Hamzah bin 'Abdul Muttalib, carrying the standard of the Muslims and laid siege to the Jews' forts for 15 days. Allâh cast fear into their hearts, and they were obliged to defer to the Messenger[pbuh]'s judgement on their lives, wealth, women and children; their hands were tied behind their backs.

Bani An-Nadeer Invasion

The behavior of the Jews fluctuate between resignation and slackness after the Banu Qainuqa' event and the murder of Ka'b bin Al-Ashraf, and rebellion coupled with treacherous clandestine contacts with Quraish and the hypocrites in order to establish an alliance against the Muslims after the battle of Uhud ['Aunul Ma'bood 3/116-117]. Being inexperienced in war tactics, they resorted to conspiracy and intrigue hatching. They first of all declared open hatred and enmity, and chose to play all sorts of tricks that might harm the Muslims, but were very careful not to initiate any sort of hostilities that might involve them in open war.

The Prophet [pbuh], on his part, exercised the highest degree of patience with them but they went too far in their provocative deeds, especially after Ar-Raji' and Ma'una Well events; they even made an attempt on his life.

Once the Prophet [pbuh] with some of his Companions set out to see Banu Nadeer and seek their help in raising the blood-money in accordance with the clauses of the treaty. they asked him and his to sit under a wall of their houses and wait. They conspired to kill the Prophet [pbuh], one of them by dropping a large millstone on his head, but

Gabriel informed their wicked criminal intention. Therefore, he, with his Companions, hurried off back to Madinah. Soon after, the Prophet [pbuh] delegated Muhammad bin Maslamah to communicate an ultimatum to Bani Nadeer to the effect that they should evacuate Madinah within ten days, otherwise, their heads would be cut off. The Jews were determined to fight while the chief of the hypocrites, 'Abdullah bin Ubai, assured to support them with two thousands of his followers, and from Quraizah. [Al-Qur'an 59:11]

The Prophet set out to fight them after appointing Ibn Umm Maktum to dispose the affairs of Madinah during his absence. The standard was entrusted to 'Ali bin Abi Talib. He laid siege to their forts for six nights — in another version, fifteen.

Banu Nadeer resorted to their castles, mounted them and started shooting arrows and pelting stones at the Muslims enjoying the strategic advantage that their thick fields of palm trees provided. The Muslims were therefore ordered to fell and burn those trees. [Al-Qur'an 59:5]

Quraizah tribe remained neutral, and the hypocrite 'Abdullah bin Ubai as well as Ghatfan failed to keep their promises of support. [Al-Qur'an 59:16]

The siege did not last long for Allâh, the All-Mighty, cast horror into the hearts of the Jews, and they willingly offered to comply with the Prophet [pbuh]'s order and leave Madinah. The Prophet [pbuh]

accepted their request and allowed them to carry as much luggage as their camels could lift, arms were excepted.

The invasion of Bani An-Nadeer took place in Rabi' Al-Awwal, 4 A.H. i.e. in August 625 A.D. Almost all the verses of *Sûrah Al-Hashr* (Chapter 59 - The Gathering) describe the banishment of the Jews and reveal the disgraceful manners of the hypocrites.

Banu Quraizah Defeated (627 A.D.)

According to the terms of the treaty which Banu Quraizah had contracted with the Muslims, they were bound to assist the Muslims against outside aggression. But, not to speak of assisting the Muslims or even remaining neutral, they had sided with the Makkans and joined the besieging foe. He was brought to the Prophet and in audacious defiance, he declared obstinate enmity to the Prophet. What was worse, they had tried to attack the fortress where Muslim women and children had been lodged for safety. Living in such a close proximity to Medina, they had become a serious menace.

Having put aside his armor after return of the Prophet from the site of the Battle of Khandaq, the arch-angel Gabriel brought him the divine command to proceed immediately against the Jews of Quraizah. He instantly sent Ali with his standard, then he followed in person with his army and laid the siege of their fortress, a siege which the enemy had not expected, thinking that the Muslims were already worn out following one of their most exhausting battles.

First, Quraizah Jews resisted, but the siege of twenty-five days sufficed to bring them to their knees and prepare them to pay for their treachery. This tribe had no choice but to surrender and comply with the Messenger's judgment. The Al-Aws tribe interceded with the Prophet asking him to be lenient with them. The Jewish tribe asked that Sa'd ibn Mu'adh, a former ally, be deputed to give verdict about them, and the Prophet agreed.

When Sa'd was informed that the Jews had agreed to accept his verdict about them, he wondered if his judgment would be acceptable to all the people present. The reply was positive. He decided that all the able-bodied male persons belonging to the tribe should be killed, women and children taken prisoners and their wealth divided among the Muslim fighters. It was in reference to this conquest that the following *ayats* were revealed:

And He drove down those of the people of the Book who backed them from their fortresses, and He cast awe into their hearts: some you killed and some you took captive. And He made you inherit their land and their dwellings and their possessions, and (to) a land which ye have not yet trodden, and God has power over all things. (Qur'an, 33:26-27)

Some critics had described this punishment as harsh. But what other punishment could be meted out to them? The Prophet Mohammad was patient, kind, forgiving and ready to reconcile in matters of dispute. He was ever ready to pardon a wrong doer if he wished forgiveness and reconciliation. Nevertheless the Jews had violated the pact and, instead of helping the Muslims, they joined the forces of their enemies and had actually besieged the Muslims, they declared obstinate enmity to the Prophet. Besides, there were no prisons where prisoners of war could be detained nor any concentration camps where they could be put to forced labor, and the capture of women and children, though allaying to the notions of the present age, was probably the only method known in those days to provide sustenance to them when the earning members of their families had lost their lives. At any rate, this was the

customary aftermath of a war. Furthermore, one would easily notice that it has been a common practice in many western countries, especially USA to order assassination of any person who may be considered a threat to that country's security. There will be no trial or proven crimes in most cases.

The Jews of Prophet Mohammad's time made continuous attempts to assassinate him. Yet, he was patient with them and gave them chances to change and offered them protection after the treaty. At some point, he had to take the necessary steps to protect the security of the new state and teach a lesson to those who were still downplaying his authority.

Jews of Banu Mostaliq (627 A.D.)

The Jews of Banu Mostaliq were neighbors of Banu Qurayzah. Although they saw what had happened to the latter, they did not learn a lesson from it and started making preparations to invade the part of Medina where the Muslims were residing. Having come to know of their designs, Prophet Muhammad sent them Buraydah ibn al-Hasib in order to verify the reports that had reached him. Upon his return, Buraydah confirmed the truth of what the Prophet had heard. A pre-emptive war was imminent. With Ali as the standard bearer, the Prophet led his troops on Sha'ban 2, 5 A.H./December 30, 626 A.D. to battle the Banu Mostaliq Jews.

The fighting broke out, and ten Jews were killed, including the leader of Banu Mostaliq, namely al-Harith ibn Abu Zarar. Having seen their leader being killed, the Jews took to flight but not before the Muslims captured two hundred of them along with one thousand camels and five hundred sheep. Juwayriyya, daughter of the slain Jewish chief, was among the captives. She embraced Islam and was married to the Prophet who safeguarded her dignity and treated her like a queen. In order to please her even more, Muhammad set all her relatives free.

The Conquest of Khaibar (In Moharram, 7A.H.)

Khaibar was a spacious strongly fortified territory, studded with castles and farms, lying at a distance of 60-80 miles north of Madinah, now a village known for its uncongenial climate. After Al-Hudaibiyah Treaty, the major party of the anti-Islam tripartite coalition — Quraish, the bedouin horde of Najd tribes and the Jews — was neutralized, therefore, the Prophet [pbuh] deemed it an appropriate time to settle his affairs with the other two wings — the Jews and the Najd tribes — in order that peace and security could prevail and the Muslims may devote their time and effort in propagating the Message of Allâh and calling people to embrace it. Khaibar itself had always remained a hotbed of intrigue and conspiracy, and the Jews had always constituted it a source of military provocations and war instigation centre, so it was given a top priority on the agenda of the Prophet's compelling exigencies. The Jews of Khaibar had united by an ancient alliance with the Confederates, triggered Bani Quraiza to practise treachery, maintained contacts with Ghatfan and the Arabians and they even devised an attempt at the Prophet's life. In fact, the continual afflictions that the Muslims had sustained were primarily attributable to the Jews. Envoys were repeatedly sent to them for peaceful settlement, but all in vain. Consequently the Prophet [pbuh] came to the conclusion that a military campaign was a must in order to forestall their hostilities.

For this reason, the Prophet [pbuh] invited only those who were willing to fight in the cause of Allâh to accompany him in his march against Khaibar. 1400 men only, who had sworn allegiance in response to his call.

The hypocrites of Arabia took notice of the fresh Islamic intentions so they began to alert the Jews to the imminent military activities. On hearing the news the Jews despatched Kinanah bin Abi Al-Huqaiq and Haudha bin Qais to their former allies, the tribe of Ghatfan requesting military assistance, promising to grant them half the yield of the fruit that their farms could yield if they managed to beat the Muslims.

The Prophet marched with his companions towards Khaibar and the following morning, at sunrise, the Muslims encountered the Jews when they had come out about their jobs with their axes, spades and strings driving their cattle along. On approaching the vicinity of Khaibar, the Prophet ordered his troops to halt, and began to invoke his Lord. In the following morning, "The banner" was given to 'Ali bin Abi Talib whose eyes used to hurt, and handed it to him. The Prophet [pbuh] ordered the Muslims to invite the Jews to accept Islam and brief them on their duties towards Allâh. Khaibar, it seems, was split into two parts with five forts in the first: Na'im, As-Sa'b bin Mu'adh, the castle of Az-Zubair, 'Abi Castle, and An-Nizar in Ash-Shiqq; three others were in part two: Al-Qamus, Al-Wateeh and As-Salalim. The Prophet [pbuh] began the campaign and started to conquer the forts by reducing the minor stronghold one after the other.

The Jews inside were too cowardly to meet the Muslims in open fight but rather hurled a shower of arrows and stones on the attackers. The besieged Jews managed to organize, under the cover of darkness, the transfer of people and treasures from one fortress to another as needed to make their resistance more effective. Later, with the series of military victories, the first division of Khaibar was totally reduced, and the Jews in the other minor fortresses evacuated them and fled to the second division.

When the Prophet [pbuh], along with his army, moved to this part of Khaibar, Al-Katiba, he laid a heavy siege to it for fourteen days with the Jews barricading themselves inside their forts. When he was about to use the rams, the Jews realized that they would perish, therefore, they asked for a negotiable peace treaty. The Prophet [pbuh] agreed to spare their lives on condition they evacuate Khaibar and the adjacent land, leaving whatever gold and silver they had in their possession.

10. The Last Sermon

"Oh Prophet, We have sent you as a witness, news bearer and a warner and as someone who invites people to God by His permission and a shining Lamp" (33:45-46).

Prophet Muhanimad (PBUH) who was sent to mankind as a news bearer and a warner for he spoke the truth and did not invent something of his own. The purpose of this article is to confirm the statements made by Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) during his farewell address during the last pilgrimage (10 AH). After praising and thanking God, the Messenger said, "Oh people, listen to my words carefully for I know not whether I will meet you on such an occasion again."

\TRUST AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Sermon: "Oh people, just as you regard this month, this day, this city as sacred, so regard the life and property of every Muslim as a sacred trust. Remember that you will indeed appear before God and answer for your actions."

Quran: *"If anyone killed a person unless it is for a murder or spreading mischief on earth it would be as if he killed the whole mankind, and if anyone who saved a life, it would be as if he saved the life of whole mankind" (5:32). "Then on that day not a soul will be wronged in the least and you shall but be prepaid in the needs of your past deeds" (36:54).*

FINANCIAL OBLIGATIONS

Sermon: "Return the things kept with you as trust (*amanah*) to their rightful owners."

Quran: *"If one of you entrusts (something) the one who has been entrusted with it should hand over his security and he should heed God and not hide any testimony. Anyone who hides it-has a sinfull heart" (2:283).*

INTEREST (RIBAH)

Sermon: "All dues of interest shall stand cancelled and you will have only your capital back. Allah has forbidden interest, and I cancel the dues of interest payable to may uncle Abbas ibn Abdul Muttalib."

Quran: *"You who believe fear God and write off anything that remains outstanding from lending at interest if you are (true) God and His Messenger If you repent you may retail your principal do not wrong and you will not be wronged" (2:278).*

TREATMENT OF WIFE (SPOUSE)

Sermon: "Oh people, your wives have a certain right over you and you have a certain right over them. Treat them well and be kind to them for they are your committed partners and committed helpers.

Quran: *"Provide for them the rich according to his income and the poor according to his means, a provision according to the custom. This is an obligation for those who act kindly" (2:236). "Treat them politely even if you dislike them,, Perhaps you dislike something in which God has placed much good" (4:19).*

WARNING ABOUT SATAN

Sermon: "Beware of Satan, he is desperate to divert you from the worship of God so beware of him in matters of your way of life."

Quran: *"Verily Satan is an enemy to you so treat him as an enemy. He only invites his followers that they may become companions of the blazing fire" (35:6).*

BROTHERHOOD

Sermon: "Oh you people listen carefully. All the believers are brothers. You are not allowed to the things belonging to another Muslim unless he give it to you willingly."

Quran: *"Believers are but brothers so set things right between your brothers and fear God so that you may find mercy" (49: 1 0).*

SUPERIORITY IS ONLY IN PIETY AND SUBMISSION

Sermon: "Oh people, no one is higher than the other unless he is higher in obedience to God. No Arab is superior to a non-Arab except in piety."

Quran: *"The most honored among you in the sight of God is (he who is) the most righteous of you and God has full knowledge and is will acquainted (with all things)" (49:134). "Who can be better in religion than he who submits his whose self to God, does good and follows the ways of abraham for God did take Abraham for a friend" (4:125).*

IN ORDER TO BE SUCCESSFUL WE MUST OBEY BOTH GOD AND HIS MESSENGER

Sermon: "Oh people, reflect on my words. I leave behind me two things, the Quran and my example and if you follow these, you will not fail."

Quran: *"And obey God and the Messenger so that you may receive mercy" (3:132).*

OBSERVE THE PILLARS OF ISLAM

Sermon: "Listen to me carefully. Worship God and offer prescribed prayer, observe fasting in the month of Ramadan and pay the poor-due."

Quran: *"And establish the prescribed prayer, practice regular charity and bow down with those who bow down" (2:43). "Oh you who believe, fasting is prescribed to you as it was prescribed to those before you that you may learn self-restraint" (2:183).*

DUTIES REGARDING THOSE WORKING UNDER US

Sermon: "Oh people, be mindful of those who work under you. Feed and clothe them as you feed and clothe yourselves."

Quran: *"Act kindly just as God treated you kindly" (28:77). "God has favored some of you over their provisions to those whom their right hand controls so that they become equal (partners) in it. Would they thus disclaim God's favor" (16:71).*

MUHAMMAD WAS THE LAST PROPHET

Sermon: "Oh people, no prophet or messenger will come after me and no new faith will emerge."

Quran: *"Muhammad is not the father of any of you men but he is God's Messenger and the Seal of Prophets. God is aware of everything" (33:40).*

OUR DUTY IS TO SPREAD THE MESSAGE OF THE PROPHET (QURAN)

Sermon: "All those who listen to me shall pass on my words to others and those to others again (and people did)."

Quran: *"Oh Messenger, communicate whatever has been sent down to you by your Lord. If you do not do so, you will not have conveyed his message" (5:67).*

Sermon: Have I conveyed the Message of God to you? asked the Prophet facing towards the heavens. The audience answered in one voice, "You have, God is the witness."

Quran: As the Messenger finished the following revelation came to him, *"Today I have perfected your religion for you, completed my favors upon you and have chosen for you Islam as the way of life for you" (5:3).*

11. Prophet Muhammad: The Leader

Prophet Muhammad had all the necessary qualities for success in every aspect of life. But, more importantly, he was able to lead his community to success in every field. He is the source from which flowed all later developments related to command, statecraft, religion, spiritual development, and so on in the Muslim world.

In general, leaders should have the following qualities:

1. *Realism:* They should understand prevailing conditions as they actually are and be aware of any advantages and disadvantages.

2. *Absolute belief in their message:* Their conviction should never falter, and they should never renounce their mission.
3. *Personal courage:* Even if left alone, they should have enough courage to persevere. When some of his pursuers reached the mouth of the cave in which they were hiding, Abu Bakr was afraid something would happen to the Messenger. However, the Prophet only said, *Grieve not, for God is with us* (At-Tawbah 9:40).
4. *Strong willpower and resolve:* They should never experience even one moment of hopelessness.
5. *Awareness of personal responsibility:* Everything should be directed toward fulfilling this responsibility. In no way should they be seduced by the world's charms and life's attractions.
6. *Far-sighted and goal-centered:* Leaders should be able to discern and plan for potential developments. They should know how to evaluate the past, present, and future to reach a new synthesis. Those who frequently change their opinions only spread chaos in the community.
7. *Personal knowledge of each follower:* Leaders should be fully aware of each follower's disposition, character, abilities, shortcomings, ambitions, and weak points. If they lack this knowledge, how can they fill vacant posts with the appropriate people?
8. *Strong character and praiseworthy virtues:* Leaders should be determined but flexible while carrying out decisions, and know when to be unyielding and implacable or relenting and compassionate. They should know when to be earnest and dignified, when to be modest, and they should always be upright, truthful, trustworthy, and just.
9. *No worldly ambitions or abuse of authority:* Leaders should live like the poorest members of their community. They should never discriminate among their subjects; rather, they should strive to love them, prefer them over themselves, and act so that their people will love them sincerely. They should be faithful to their community, and secure their community's loyalty and devotion in return.

The Messenger possessed all of these qualities and many more as well. To cite only a few examples, he never even thought of abandoning his mission when confronted with great hostility and tempting bribes. Instead, he would tell them, **“Say: ‘There is no god but Allah,’ and prosper (in both worlds)”** (Al-Hakim). When his Companions complained about the harsh conditions and persecution in Makkah, he answered, **“By Allah, Allah will bring this matter (the establishment of Islam) to its consummation till a rider will travel from San‘a’ (in Yemen) to Hadramaut fearing none but Allah, or a wolf as regards his sheep, but you (people) are hasty”** (Al-Bukhari).

12. Some Moral Attributes of the Prophet Muhammad (saw)

1. **Sound Intellect:** The Messenger (pbuh) had an excellent, complete and sound intellect. No man has ever had an intellect as complete and perfect as his. Qadhi Iyaadh¹⁶, may Allah have mercy on him, said:

He was an example and paradigm to which his people could relate to in all branches of knowledge; acts of worship, medicine, laws of inheritance, lineage, and other matters as well. He knew and learned all of this without reading or examining the Scriptures of those before us, nor did he sit with their scholars. The Prophet (pbuh) was wise to the fullest extent of his mental capacity.

2. Doing Things for the Sake of Allah: The Prophet (pbuh) would always do deeds through which he would seek the pleasure of Allah. He was harmed and abused when he invited and called people to Islam; yet he was patient and endured all of this, and hoped for the reward of Allah. He said during his finger bleeding in one of the battles: “You are but a finger which has bled; which suffers in the path of Allah.” (Bukhari, 2648)

3. Sincerity: The Prophet (pbuh) was sincere and honest in all his matters, as Allah had ordered him. Allah, the Exalted, says: “Say, Indeed, my prayer, my rites of sacrifice, my living and my dying are for Allah, Lord of the worlds. No partner has He. And this I have been commanded and I am the first (among you) of the Muslims.” [6:162-163]

4. Good Morals, Ethics and Companionship: The Prophet (pbuh) was a living example for all humans to follow. His wife A’ishah was asked about his manners, and she said, “His manners were the Qur’an.” Allah, the Exalted, said: “And indeed, you are of a great moral character” [68:4] Anas b. Malik said: “The Prophet (pbuh) did not swear at anyone, nor was he rude, nor did he curse anyone. If he desired to reprimand someone, he would say: ‘What is wrong with him, may dust be cast in his face!’” (Bukhari #5684)

5. Politeness and Good Manners: The Prophet (pbuh) showed good manners and was courteous to all, even to children. Once when the Prophet was in a gathering, a drink was brought to the Prophet (pbuh) and he drank from it. On his right side there was a young boy and on his left side were elderly men. Feeling obliged by the respect of elders, and not wanting to hurt the feelings of the child, he asked the young boy: “Do you mind if I give the drink to them?” The young boy said: ‘O Prophet of Allah! By Allah! I would not prefer anyone to drink from the place you drank. This is my fair share¹⁸.’ The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) handed the boy the drink.” (Bukhari #2319)

6. Love for Reformation and Reconciliation: Whenever a situation occurred which called for reconciliation, the Prophet (pbuh) would hurry to resolve it. Once when he heard that the people of Qubaa’ disputed with each other about a matter, the Prophet (pbuh) said: “Let us go to resolve the situation and make peace between them.” (Bukhari #2547)

7. Ordering with the good and forbidding evil: If the Prophet (pbuh) saw an act which opposed a tenet of the religion, he would reprimand it in a suitable manner. Abu Saeed al-Khudri said: I heard the Messenger of Allah say: “Whoever of you sees an evil action, let him change it with his hand; and if he is not able to do so, then with his tongue; and if he is not able to do so, then with his heart...” (Muslim)

8. Love of Purification: A companion passed by the Prophet (pbuh) while he was not in a state of purification. He greeted him with Allah’s name, but the Prophet (pbuh) did not return the greeting until he performed ablution and apologized saying: “I disliked that I should mention Allah’s name while I am not in a state of purity.” (Ibn Khuzaimah #206)

9. Safeguarding and Minding One’s Language: The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) would busy himself with the remembrance of Allah; he would not talk in vain. He would lengthen his prayers and shorten the speech, and he would not hesitate to help and take care of the needs of a needy, poor or widow. (Ibn Hibban # 6423)

10. Excelling in Acts of Worship: A'ishah said that the Prophet of Allah (pbuh) used to pray during the night until his feet would swell. She said, 'Why do you do this, O Messenger of Allah, while Allah has forgiven your past and future sins?' The Prophet (pbuh) replied: "Shall I not be a grateful slave (of Allah)?" (Bukhari #4557)

11. Forbearance: Once some companions came to the Prophet (pbuh) complaining about a tribe, namely the Daws, who refused to accept Islam, asking him to curse them. The Prophet (pbuh) raised his hands in prayer and instead said: "O Allah guide the tribe of Daws and bring them to Islam!"

12. Good Appearance: The companions knew the Prophet (pbuh) to be the most beautiful of people. One companion said: "The Prophet (pbuh) was a person of average height. His shoulders were wide. His hair reached his earlobes. Once I saw him adorned in a red garment; I never saw anything more beautiful than him." (Bukhari #2358)

13. Asceticism in Worldly Affairs: There are many examples in the Prophet's life which prove that he had no concern for the pleasures of this life. Abdullah b. Masood said: "The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) went to sleep on a mat. He stood up and he had marks on his side due to the mat that he had slept on. We said: 'O Messenger of Allah, shall we not make [a proper] bedding for you?' He said: 'What do I have to do with this world? I am only like a wayfarer upon a mount that stopped to take shade and rest under a tree, and then leaves it behind and continues on the journey.'" (Tirmidhi #2377)

Amr' b. al-Haarith said: "The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) did not leave any gold or silver currency, or a slave, male or female, after his death. He only left behind his white mule, his weapons and a piece of land which he declared as Charity." ((Bukhari #2588)

14. Altruism (Unselfishness): Sahl b. Sa'd said: The Prophet (pbuh) had more care for those around him than for his own self. "A woman gave the Messenger of Allah (pbuh) a Burdah (gown). The Prophet (pbuh) asked his Companions: 'Do you know what a Burdah is?' They replied, 'Yes, O Prophet of Allah! It is a piece of woven cloth [similar to a shawl]. The woman said: 'O Prophet of Allah! I have woven this shawl with my own hands, for you to wear.' The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) took it while he direly needed it. After a while, the Messenger of Allah (pbuh) came out of his home wearing it, and a Companion said to the Messenger of Allah (pbuh): 'O Prophet of Allah! Grant me this shawl to wear!' The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) said: 'Yes.' He then sat for awhile, and headed back home, folded it and gave it to the person who asked for it. The Companions scolded him saying: 'It was not appropriate for you to ask for his shawl; especially since you know he does not turn anyone down or send them away empty-handed! The man said: 'By Allah! I only asked him to give it to me because I want to be shrouded in this shawl when I die.' Sahl, the narrator of the Hadeeth said: 'The shawl was used as a shroud for that man when he died.'" (Bukhari #1987)

15. Strong Faith and Dependence on Allah: Although the Prophet (pbuh) and his companions faced severe trials from the disbelievers, he always reminded them that the end was for the believers, and that the Will of Allah will come to pass. When Abu Bakr and the Prophet hid in a cave after they had left their homes in order to migrate to Madeenah, the disbelievers of Makkah had sent scouts in search of them. They came so close to the cave that Abu Bakr could see their feet. Abu Bakr said: "I looked at the feet of the pagans while we were in the cave [of Thawr]. I said, 'O Prophet of Allah! If anyone of

them looks down at his feet he would see us!’ The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) said: ‘O Abu Bakr! What do you think of two with whom Allah, the Exalted, is their Third?’ (Muslim #1854)

16. Kindness and Compassion: The Prophet was the kindest of people, and this was also apparent in his treatment of infants. “The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) performed Salah (prayer) while he was carrying an infant girl named Umaamah, daughter of Abul-Aas. When he bowed, he put her on the ground, and when he stood up, he would carry her again.” (Bukhari #5650)

17. Simplification and Ease: The Prophet (pbuh) always sought to make things easy for people. The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) said: “I start the prayer with the intention of lengthening it, but when I hear a child crying, I shorten the prayer, as I know its mother would suffer from his screams!” (Bukhari #677)

18. Fearing Allah, being Mindful to not trespass His Limits: The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) said: “Sometimes, when I return to my family, I would find a datefruit on the bed. I would pick it up to eat it; but I would fear that it was from the charity²¹, and thus, throw it back [on the ground].” (Bukhari #2300)

19. Spending Generously: Ibn Abbas said: ‘The Prophet (pbuh) was the most generous of people. He was most generous during Ramadhan when he met Gabriel (pbuh); he would meet him every night during Ramadhan to practice and review the Qur’an with him. The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) was so generous, that he was faster than the swiftest wind in this regard. (Bukhari #6)

Jabir b. Abdullah said: ‘The Prophet pbuh did not refuse to give anything which he had to someone if he asked for it.’ (Bukhari #5687)

20. Cooperation: The Prophet (pbuh) was not a king who commanded his followers to carry out his orders. Rather he always carried out his own affairs and helped others in collective duties. For example, he helped and assisted his family members, and the Messenger of Allah (pbuh) on the Day of the Trench carried dirt [that was dug from the trench] until his chest was covered with dirt.” (Bukhari #2780)

21. Truthfulness: He is glorified with truthfulness and he never told a lie. Nevertheless, “The trait and characteristic which the Prophet (pbuh) hated most was lying. (Tirmidhi #1973) Even his enemies attested to his truthfulness. Abu Jahl, who was one of the harshest enemies of Islam, said: ‘O Muhammad! I do not say that you are a liar! I only deny what you brought and what you call people to.’ Allah, the Exalted, says: “We know indeed that what they say certainly grieves you, but surely they do not call you a liar; but the unjust deny the verses of Allah.” [6:33]

22. Aggrandizing the limits set by Allah, and Always Seeking the Moderate Path

A’ishah said: “The Prophet (pbuh) was not given a choice between two matters, except that he chose the easier of the two, as long as it was not a sinful act. If that act was a sinful act, he would be the farthest from it. By Allah! He never avenged himself. He only became angry when people transgressed the limits and boundaries of Allah; in that case he avenged [for the sake of Allah].” (Bukhari #6404)

23. Pleasant Facial Expression: Abdullah bin al-Harith said: “I have never seen a man who smiled as much as the Messenger of Allah (pbuh).” (Tirmidhi #2641)

24. Honesty, Trustworthiness and Reliability: The Prophet (pbuh) was well known for his honesty, trustworthiness and reliability. For example of his honesty, trustworthiness and reliability is demonstrated in the Truce of Hudaibiyah, wherein he agreed to the article in the treaty which stated that any man who left the Prophet (pbuh) would not be returned to him, and any man who left Makkah would be returned to them. Before the treaty was concluded a man named Abu Jandal b. Amr had managed to escape from the pagans of Makkah and rushed to join Muhammad (pbuh). The pagans asked Muhammad to honor his pledge and return the escapee. The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) said: “O Abu Jandal! Be patient and ask Allah to grant you patience. Allah will surely help you and those who are persecuted and make it easy for you. We have signed an agreement with them, and we certainly do not betray or act treacherously.” (Baihaquee #18611)

25. Bravery and courage: Ali said: “On Day of Badr, the Messenger of Allah (pbuh) was the strongest one among us.” (Ahmed #654)

As for his courage and bravery under normal circumstances - Anas b. Malik said: “The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) was the best of people and the most courageous. One night, the people of Madeenah were frightened and headed towards the sounds they heard during the night. The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) met them He was riding a horse without any saddle, and he had his sword with him. He was assuring the people, saying: ‘Do not be frightened! Do not be frightened!’” (Bukhari #2751)

26. Bashfulness and Modesty: Abu Ayoub al-Ansari said that the Messenger of Allah (pbuh) said: “Four (traits) are from the practice of the Messengers; modesty, using perfume and siwak (tooth stick) and marriage.” (Tirmidhi)

27. Humbleness: The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) was the most humble person. He was so humble that if a stranger were to enter the mosque and approach the Prophet’s sitting place while he was sitting with his Companions, one would not be able to distinguish him from his Companions.

The Prophet (pbuh) would not hesitate to help the poor, needy and widows in their needs. Anas b. Malik said: “A woman from the people of Madeenah who was partially insane said to the Prophet (pbuh): ‘I have to ask you [your help] about something.’ He helped her and took care of her needs.” (Bukhari #670)

28. Mercy and Compassion: Prophet (saw) said when a man complained regarding the lengthened the Fajr prayer: “If you lead people in prayer, shorten the prayer. There are old and weak people and those with special needs behind you in prayer.” (Bukhari #670)

Once when the Prophet (pbuh) went to visit his grandchild he shed some tears. He said: ‘This (weep) is a mercy that Allah, the Exalted, places in the hearts of His slaves. Truly, Allah is merciful to those who are merciful towards others.’ (Bukhari #6942)

29. Patience and Forbearance: A Bedouin grabbed the Prophet strongly and asked some wealth. The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) turned to the Bedouin, laughed and ordered that he be given [some money].” (Bukhari #2980)

Another example of his patience is the story of the Jewish Rabbi, Zaid bin Sa’nah. Zaid had given something as a loan to the Messenger of Allah (pbuh). Zaid came towards the prophet and grabbed him by the edges of his cloak, and looked at him in a harsh way, and said: ‘O Muhammad! Will you not

pay me back my loan? I have not known the family of Abdul-Mutalib to delay in repaying debts!’ The Prophet (pbuh) ordered Omar in peaceful manner to repay him his loan although Omar became angry with Zaid. After a while both Zaid and Umar returned to the Messenger of Allah (pbuh). Zaid declared his faith in Allah and His Messenger. He believed in him, and witnessed many battles and then died in the Battle of Tabook while he was encountering the enemy - may Allah have mercy on Zaid.’ (Ibn Hibban #288)

It is also noted that his forgiveness and perseverance is apparent when he pardoned the people of Makkah after its conquest. (See, Baihaqi #18055)

30. Patience: The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) was the epitome of patience. He was patient with his people before calling them to Islam; for they would worship idols and do sinful acts. He was patient and tolerant with the abuse and harm the pagans of Makkah inflicted on him and his Companions and sought the reward of Allah. He was also patient and tolerant with the abuse of the hypocrites in Madeenah. His patience was severely tested when he lost his loved ones. His wife, Khadeejah, died during his lifetime, as did all his children, save his daughter, Fatimah. His uncle Hamzah and Abu Talib passed away as well. The Prophet (pbuh) was patient and sought the reward of Allah. (See: Bukhari #1241)

31. Justice and Fairness: The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) was just and fair in every aspect of his life and in the application of the religion. A’ishah said: Usamah spoke to the Messenger of Allah (pbuh) regarding the woman who committed a theft. The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) said: By Allah! If Fatimah, the daughter of Muhammad stole, I would cut her hand off.’ (Bukhari #3288)

The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) was just and fair and allowed others to avenge themselves if he harmed them. One day the Prophet allowed a man of Ansar to avenge and said: ‘Go Ahead!’ The man said: ‘O Messenger of Allah, you are wearing a garment, and I was not when you poked me [i.e. you jabbed my exposed skin, so it is only fair I do the same to you]!’ The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) raised his upper garment [to expose his side], and the Ansari [merely] kissed it, saying: ‘I only meant to do this, O Messenger of Allah!’ (Abu Dawood #5224)

32. Fearing Allah, and Being Mindful of Him

The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) was the most mindful person of Allah. Abdullah bin Masoud started to recite Surat an-Nisaa before the Prophet until he reached the verse: “How then if We brought from each nation a witness, and We brought you as a witness against these people!” (4:41) Upon hearing this verse, the Messenger of Allah (pbuh) said: ‘That is enough!’ Abdullah b. Masood said, ‘I turned around and saw the Messenger of Allah (pbuh) crying.’ (Bukhari #4763)

33. Richness and Contentment of the Heart: Once Umar wept, and the Messenger (pbuh) asked him: ‘Why do you weep?’ Umar said: ‘O Prophet of Allah! Khosrau and Caesar enjoy the best of this world, and you are suffering in poverty?!’ He said: ‘Aren’t you pleased that they enjoy this world, and we will enjoy the Hereafter?’ (Bukhari #4629)

34. Hoping for Goodness, Even for his Enemies: A’ishah said: The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) suffered a lot from the people on the Day of al-’Aqabah especially when ‘Ali b. Abd Yaleel b. Abd Kilaal (in order to support me) disappointed to him and left him. At that time the Angel said: O

Muhammad, I will do whatever you command me to do. If you like I can bring the Akh-shabain mountains together and crush them all.' The Messenger of Allah (pbuh) said: 'It may be that Allah raises from among them a progeny (children) who worship Allah alone and associate no partners with Him.' (Shortened) (Bukhari #3059)

13. Prophet Muhammad as a Reformer

Muhammad was a prophet, warrior, businessman, statesman, orator and reformer, among other things. This article is about Muhammad as a reformer. Pre-Islamic Arabia was dominated by tribal fighting, tribal laws, murder, cruelty, exploitation, theft, adultery, infanticide, false contracts, usury, and few rights for women and children. The Constitution of Medina, or Charter of Medina, made by Muhammad in 622 CE, was in the form of an agreement between himself and the Yathrib tribes to stop their fighting and allow a series of reforms, including various rights and responsibilities, to apply to Muslims, Jews and pagans.

The constitution involved sweeping reforms that reads more like something from nineteenth or early twentieth century western society than from the seventh century. Under the charter, divine law overrode customary law, women and children were given rights, a system of law and order was put in place, religious freedoms were granted, aristocratic privilege was denounced, judicial and taxation systems were introduced, and there were new business regulations.

Muhammad condemned the inferior **status of women and children** in society and introduced many reforms in this area, including to marriage, divorce, inheritance, education, female infanticide, social security for women and her children, family values, and so on. The lack of limitations on males to marry or divorce was changed to the concept of restricted polygamy. A dowry, which had previously been given to the bride's father, was retained by the woman as her personal property. Marriage itself became a contract, with the usual rules of offer and acceptance, rather than just a status symbol for the man. A woman's consent was needed before there was a marriage contract.

Inheritance had previously been restricted to males. Muhammad changed this and gave women inheritance rights. Women became the legal owners of assets they brought into the family and of those resulting from their work. They were maintained financially while married and for a certain period after divorce. Before Muhammad, women were part of a man's property, could not own property themselves, and any inheritance went straight to the man's sons.

Under his reforms, **children** were no longer the property of their father's. Muhammad gave them the right to have food, clothing and shelter, to be loved, to receive an education, and to be provided for in an inheritance. Siblings were to be treated equally. Female infanticide was outlawed. Adoption was replaced with the concept that people had to regard children of unknown origin in the same way as family members. A man was forbidden to have sexual relations with his mother or sister, something that occurred in pre-Islamic times. As an orphan himself, Muhammad declared that orphans were to be treated well.

Another important reform related to **slavery**. Muhammad ensured that a person had the right to be free, except in a few circumstances. While slavery was still allowed, it was regulated. Slaves had legal

status and were given certain rights. They had to be treated kindly, in much the same way as other disadvantaged members of society. Slaves could receive alms or earn money and be released from slavery, which was something recommended by Muhammad. War captives received food and clothing either from the government or from the person who held them.

Equality was emphasized. Important positions within society were open to all comers instead of being restricted to the aristocracy, and value was placed on all individuals. All members of society were expected to be committed to and participate in the reforms. Feuding tribes were brought together. Monotheism was introduced to replace the previous multitude of gods. Emphasis was placed on piety and humility. People were expected to follow God rather than ancestral traditions or trying to achieve fame.

Economic reforms revolved around the economics of poverty. Muhammad was keen to see the poor given a better deal. Instead of paupers having to borrow at high rates of interest and suffer even more, the well-off were to provide alms to the needy, regardless of whether the parties knew each other. Goods were to be circulated, and purified, via charity. This was done without taxes or fees, buildings or profit. It was also to be done on a voluntary basis. Today we have elaborate taxation and social security systems to achieve the same thing.

Public construction occurred on a wide scale. Muhammad built wells and canals for the general public. By limiting the use of land and practicing urban planning, he made sure that resources were not over-utilized, thereby preserving the environment. He is regarded as a pioneer in environmentalism.

On the **political front**, Muhammad observed the warring tribes and the persecution. A series of conquests made the new Islamic state the region's dominant power, although little was destroyed in the process. Muhammad's reforms had resulted in greater tolerance towards those of other faiths. Christians were tolerated and, while they could only practice in private, they weren't subjected to persecution. In fact, Jews and Christians enjoyed greater religious freedom than before.

The Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) was a role model for **religious freedom**, for instance when the Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) entered the city of Medina, he made a formal constitution with the large Jewish population of the city, and indeed, this was a historic moment and in this constitution it guaranteed religious freedom for those who were and weren't Muslims. So the constitution of Medina guaranteed religious freedom for the large Jewish community, and on top of this, the Jewish tribes were declared as being one with the Muslims!

Another example of the Prophet Muhammad's (pbuh) religious tolerance was when a large group of Christian learned men came to Medina, the Najran Christians, they came to Medina and they remained in the Prophet Muhammad's (pbuh) company for 3 days. The Christians debated and discussed many issues with the Prophet, such as the true nature of Jesus and so forth. The Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) even allowed the Christians to pray in the Mosque. The fact that the Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) allowed the Christians to debate with him on religious matters in his own mosque showed that he had no problems in differing religious beliefs, not only did the Prophet debate them, he eventually even made a treaty with them that guaranteed their religious freedom as well.

In summary, Muhammad took a brutal tribal system where most people had few rights and converted it into an egalitarian society where everyone was given an opportunity, from women and children to slaves, the poor, and even those of other faiths

Muhammad: The Greatest Reformer, the Most Influential Man in History

It is very easy for anyone to praise his or her hero, to boost him to the skies. But when the praise comes from the outsider, it is praise indeed.

Allah praises Muhammad (pbuh)

“Most certainly O Muhammad you are on the pinnacle of behavior” (Ch 68 V 4)

Michael H Hart, an American, Astronomer, Mathematician and Historian studies the most influential men in history and gives a list of the top 100 most influential men. He lists them in order of their impact or influence over mankind. This man puts Muhammad at number 1. The main reason for putting Muhammad at the top was because Muhammad was “supremely successful” in both religious and secular realms. He writes “Muhammad was the only man in history who was supremely successful on both the religious and secular levels”, and this “entitles Muhammad to be considered the most influential single figure in human history.”

Muhammad (pbuh) is the last and final Messenger of God. It is because of him that there are more than 1.6 billion Muslims in the world, second only to Christians with 2.3 billion³. After returning successfully to Mecca, Muhammad did not establish a religious state; he established a secular state in which everyone was given freedom of religion.

In the Time Magazine, there were a series of essays under the heading ‘Who Were History’s Great Leaders?’ Jules Masserman, a US Psychoanalyst, picked Muhammad as his greatest leader. He chose his greatest prophet Moses at number two. He says that leaders must fulfil three functions: a. Provide for the well being of the led; b. Provide a social organization in which people feel relatively secure and; c. provide them with a set of beliefs. He writes:

“People like Pasteur and Salk are leaders in the first sense. People like Gandhi and Confucius, on one hand, and Alexander and Caesar on the other, are leaders in the second and perhaps the third sense. Jesus and Buddha belong in the third category alone. Perhaps the greatest leader of all time was Muhammad, who combined all three functions. To a lesser degree, Moses did the same.”

Muhammad worked for the betterment of the **society**; he turned the disorganized Arab people into a meaningful group. The system of *zakat* (charity) gave the poor financial security, they were all united in times of war and they all believed that there is no god but Allah. The people still today are influenced by him and his teachings. Muslim, as a whole do not drink alcohol, they do not gamble, they pray five times a day, they pay *zakat*, they fast. There are black sheep in every community but in totality Muslims follow this man the most. Although now we see that because of the deliberate faulty teachings Muslims are getting confused regarding what to do and whom to follow?

“If greatness of purpose, smallness of means, and astonishing results are the three criteria of a human genius, who could dare compare any great man in history with Muhammad?”, said LaMartaine in 1854.

Muhammad’s goal was to spread the message of Islam, free from all superstition, barbarism, violence. His purpose was to restore the rational and sacred idea of divinity amidst the chaos of the material and disfigured gods of idolatry that existed then.

Muhammad had a very humble beginning. There was no silver spoon to feed him. Two words describe his life: simple and struggling. Muhammad had no education to back him up, no royalty to back him up, and no political party to back him up.

Indeed with his great purpose and smallness of means he produced outstanding result: over 1.6 billion people follow him.

La Martaine concludes about Muhammad (pbuh)

“Philosopher, Orator, Apostle, Legislator, Conqueror of Ideas, Restorer of Rational beliefs.... The founder of twenty terrestrial empires and of one spiritual empire, that is Muhammad. As regards all standards by which human greatness may be measured, we may well ask, is there any man greater than he? ”

His greatness lies in the acts of reformation. He turned Arabia upside down and in a century’s time it became the diamond of the world. Because of his teachings the “Dark Ages” still had a glimmer of light as the Muslims were shining in every field. They were at the top of the world; they were top scientists, poets, writers, architectures, astronomers etc.

Muhammad is the greatest reformer who preached against the social evils of the day. He condemned female infanticide.

“And when the female (infant) buried alive (as the pagan Arabs used to do) shall be questioned. For what sin she was killed? (At-Takwir 81:8-9)

Muhammad was **against killings** that were very common at that time.

“If anyone kills any human being, Muslim or non-Muslim, it is as though he has killed the whole of humanity and if anyone saves any human being, Muslim or non Muslim, it is as though he has saved the whole of humanity.” Ch 5 v 32)

Muhammad bought **slaves** and freed them. He said that treating and freeing of slaves will lead people to get closer to Heaven and distant from the fires of hell.

Muhammad gave **women** the right to inherit. Annemarie Schimmel states that “Compared to the pre-Islamic position of women, Islamic legislation meant an enormous progress; the woman has the right, at least according to the letter of the law, to administer the wealth she has brought into the family or has earned by her own work.”⁶

According to sociologist Robert N.Bellah, Islam was “remarkably modern” for the time. This was because of the equality of all Muslims. Leadership position was open to all. All persons are equal in the sight of Allah but they can gain a higher status through taqwa i.e., God consciousness, piety.

Muhammad's last few words were:

“All mankind is from Adam and Eve, an Arab has no superiority over a non-Arab nor a non-Arab has any superiority over an Arab; also a white has no superiority over black nor does a black have any superiority over white except by piety and good deed.”⁷

(This article is highly inspired by the comment made by Mr. Ghulam Mohiyuddin on my previous article ‘Muhammad: The Most Misunderstood Man in the World’⁸: “Our Prophet was one of the greatest reformers the world has known. Unfortunately his followers failed to realize that reform is an ongoing process, and banned reform!”)

THE GREAT EXEMPLAR TO HUMANITY

Muslim children learn early that the Prophet Muhammad is the ultimate role model. Being such a universal model, he therefore becomes the example that is copied from sunrise to sundown throughout the Muslim world. This tradition of imitation is not confined to the domain of rituals. Muslims not only pray like their role model, they also fast in his tradition and offer sacrifices during their pilgrimage to Mecca in like manner. This attempt to follow in the Prophet's footsteps has led to many little traditions within Islam. These approaches to the prophetic examples have become institutionalized in the branches and sects of Islam. The Sunni-Shiite divide, which has continued to plague Muslims throughout their fifteen centuries of history, is wreaking havoc in Pakistan, Iraq, Lebanon, and a few other places where sectarianism has replaced the spirit of cooperation of the early Muslims. But even these antagonists, who have consistently tried to outdo each other in their fidelity to the prophetic example, agree on a wide range of issues regarding his life, activities, and examples of ways people could live in this world and prepare themselves for the hereafter. Evidence for this claim lies in the points of convergence and divergence between the five legal schools of Islamic jurisprudence. Whatever his school, a Muslim faces the qiblah (points facing Mecca) when offering prayers to Allah, goes through the bodily motions associated with the prophetic example of salat (prayer), does the hajj (pilgrimage) by circumambulating the Kaaba, and attends to other details central to this ritual.

Muhammad is an example to Muslims in many other ways. According to tradition, he is the example par excellence in family life. Although he married more than once, for more than twenty years, he knew only one woman, Khadijah. However, his thirteen years of life in exile and refuge in Medina made him a polygamist. Muslims and non-Muslims have spent a great deal of time arguing about this marital status. Believers who have accepted the prophetic legacy of polygamous relationships see it as a special case demanded by historical and political circumstances. They peg their arguments on the political utility of these matches and on the fact that the Prophet was an old man when he consummated such marriages. Nonapologetic Muslims simply embrace this example as an opportunity that is available. While affirming such things, they also acknowledge the Qur'anic stipulation that the man who decides to have more than one wife needs to ask himself whether he can be fair and just in his dealings with these women.

The prophetic model of family life has continued to exercise much influence. Although monogamy is the dominant form of marriage in most Muslim societies, rich and poor Muslims have taken full advantage of this Qur'anically sanctioned opportunity. Sociologists may lament the fact that many a Muslim male has engaged in polygamous relationships by citing the prophetic example, but the fact remains that people sometimes deliberately ignore the conditional clause that accompanies the granting of such opportunities.

The Prophet Muhammad's exemplary role is also evident in politics, diplomacy, warfare, and several other areas of life. In politics, he showed the Arabians of his time the benefits of unity and the strength of coalition building. This exercise in political sagacity was most evident in the years of exile, when Muhammad and his companions were at the mercy of Medinans and other Arab tribes who were willing to form alliances with him and his movement. Some of his Orientalist critics read the historical record differently and blame him for pursuing worldly ambitions. Muslim believers have always refuted these charges as unfounded and bigoted. Regardless of how one may feel about this characterization, the modern world provides a living testimony to the continuity of the prophetic example. The rise of Islamic movements in our day and the claims they make for themselves have made it categorically clear that what happened in Medina many centuries ago still reverberates in the firmaments of Muslim political debate. Although most Muslims around the globe may not embrace an Islamic fundamentalist view of reality, they would not deny these groups' claims that the governments of their countries are often corrupt and inept and that there should be change for the better.

An example of the Prophet's message being widely misunderstood and distorted often centers on the question of jihad. Often translated as "holy war" and pressed to serve in any ideological contest between non-Muslims and Muslims, this term has assumed negative connotations in many Western and some non-Western languages. In its original meaning, it was used to encapsulate the spirit of struggling on the path of Allah. The idea of jihad was originally meant to underscore the precarious nature of the young Muslim community in Medina. Caught between the Meccan enemies and unreliable partners whom the Qur'an called hypocrites, and being willing and ready to sacrifice their lives in case of all-out war with the opponents of Islam, the Prophet's followers were told to struggle at two levels. The first and greater jihad was the conquering of the ego in the service of Allah. The second struggle was the defense and maintenance of the Islamic boundary line that separates those who believe in God and those who do not. It was in this context, according to Muslim tradition, that Muhammad told his companions after the victory of Badr that they were leaving one battlefield for another. When the companions asked what he meant, he clarified by saying that warfare against one's worldly enemy was the secondary jihad. The primary jihad is the war against one's soul.